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Incremental secondary analysis of nucleic acid sequences

Abstract

Methods, systems, and apparatuses, including computer programs, for performing incremental secondary analysis of nucleic acid sequence reads. The method can include (i) obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval, (ii) obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, wherein while the second data is being obtained: (a) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data as an input to a mapping and alignment unit, (b) receiving, from the mapping and alignment unit, alignment results, and (c) storing the received alignment results, and, thereafter (iii) instructing the mapping and alignment unit to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/988,374 filed Mar. 11, 2020, the entire contents of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) This disclosure relates to nucleic acid sequence analysis.

(2) A nucleic acid sequencer is an instrument that is configured to automate the process of nucleic acid sequencing. Nucleic acid sequencing is a process of determining an order of nucleotides in a nucleic acid sequence. Nucleic acids may include deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) or ribonucleic acid (RNA).

(3) The nucleic acid sequencer is configured to receive a nucleic acid sample and generate output data, referred to as one or more “reads” that each represent an order of nucleotides in the nucleic acid sample. The nucleotides in a DNA sample can include one or more bases that include guanine (G), cytosine (C), adenine (A), and thymine (T) in any combination. The nucleotides in a RNA sample can include one or more bases that include G, C, A, and uracil (U) in any combination.

(4) The reads generated by the DNA sequencer can be mapped to a known sequence of nucleotides of a reference genome using a mapping and aligning engine. The mapping of reads to a known sequence of nucleotides of the reference genome can be achieved by a mapping and aligning engine using a hash table index.

SUMMARY

(5) The present disclosure is directed towards systems, methods, and computer programs for performing incremental secondary analysis. Incremental secondary analysis relates to the process of performing one or more secondary analysis operations on a nucleic acid read of a sample before nucleic acid sequencing of the sample is completed by a nucleic acid sequencer. The one or more secondary analysis operations can include nucleic acid read mapping, nucleic acid read aligning, variant calling, or any combination thereof.

(6) According to one innovative aspect of the present disclosure, a method for performing incremental secondary analysis of nucleic acid sequence reads is disclosed. In one aspect, the method includes actions of (i) obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval, wherein each of the first reads represents a first ordered sequence of nucleotides, (ii) obtaining second data describing a plurality

of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, wherein each of the second reads represents a second ordered sequence of nucleotides, wherein while the second data is being obtained: (a) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data as an input to a mapping and alignment unit, (b) receiving, from the mapping and alignment unit, alignment results; and (c) storing the received alignment results, and, thereafter (iii) instructing the mapping and alignment unit to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

(7) Other versions include corresponding systems, apparatus, and computer programs to perform the actions of methods defined by instructions encoded on computer readable storage devices.

(8) These and other versions may optionally include one or more of the following features. For instance, in some implementations, at least a portion of the mapping and alignment unit is implemented using a programmable logic device.

(9) In some implementations, the programmable circuit is a field programmable gate array (FPGA).

(10) In some implementations, at least a portion of the mapping and alignment unit is implemented using an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC).

(11) In some implementations, the mapping and alignment unit is included within the nucleic acid sequencing device.

(12) In some implementations, one or more of the first reads includes data representing a first sample identifier, and one or more of the second reads includes data representing a second sample identifier.

(13) In some implementations, the method can further include while the second data is being obtained: organizing the one or more first reads into respective groups based on at least a first sample identifier or a second sample identifier, and generating organization statistics, the organization statistics indicating a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier.

(14) In some implementations, the method can further include providing output data that represents the stored alignment results corresponding to the plurality of first reads before or while aligning the second portion of the cluster of reads.

(15) In some implementations, the method can further include instructing the mapping and alignment module to begin a subsequent alignment of the data representing the first plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

(16) In some implementations, the method can further include while obtaining the second data, determining a set of likely variants for the first data representing the first plurality of reads that was aligned to the reference sequence.

(17) In some implementations, the at least a portion of the second data representing the second plurality of reads is aligned while at least a different portion of second data representing the second plurality of reads is being obtained.

(18) In some implementations, the mapping and alignment unit is instructed to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads a predetermined number of sequencing cycles before the second data is completely obtained.

(19) Unless otherwise defined, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this invention belongs. Although methods and materials similar or equivalent to those described herein can be used in the practice or testing of the present invention, suitable methods and materials are described below. All publications, patent applications, patents, and other references mentioned herein are incorporated by reference in their entirety. In case of conflict, the present specification, including definitions, will control. In addition, the materials, methods, and examples are illustrative only and not intended to be limiting.

(20) Other features and advantages of the invention will be apparent from the following detailed description, and from the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a schematic showing an example of a prior art workflow describing a linear sequence of secondary analysis operations.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a contextual diagram of an example of a system for performing incremental secondary analysis on one or more samples using a secondary analysis unit located within a nucleic acid sequencer.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a flowchart of an example of a process for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 1B.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a contextual diagram of an example of a system for performing incremental secondary analysis of one or more samples using a secondary analysis unit that is located remote from the nucleic acid sequencer
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of an example of a process for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 3.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a contextual diagram of an example of a system for performing incremental secondary analysis of one or more samples using a secondary analysis unit within a nucleic acid sequencer.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of an example of a process for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 5.
- (8) FIG. 7 is an example of a workflow diagram describing a workflow of operations executed during a process for performing incremental secondary analysis using a secondary analysis unit.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of an example of a process for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 7.
- (10) FIG. 9 is flowchart of an example of a process for performing dynamic programmable circuit context-switching.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a block diagram of an example of system components that can be used to implement a system for performing incremental secondary analysis.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (12) Nucleic acid sequencing of a biological sample by a nucleic acid sequencer is a time consuming and expensive task. Conventional systems have employed a linear workflow such as the linear workflow shown in FIG. 1A. Such conventional workflows linearly execute, in series, operations that include (i) primary analysis to generate nucleic acid sequencing reads, (ii) secondary analysis on the generated nucleic acid sequencing reads to generate aligned reads and variants, and in some instances, (iii) tertiary analysis using results of secondary analysis such as variants identified during variant calling. Tertiary analysis can include, for example, classification of identified variants, determining relevance of identified variants, determining a diagnosis based on identified variants, determining treatment based on the identified variants, or the like.
- (13) With reference to FIG. 1A, a conventional workflow 170A is described that performs sequencing run 172A of one or more samples. The sequencing run 172A includes a clustering operation during time T1, a first read interval “Read 1” that includes sequencing operations to generate first reads of a sample during time T2A, and a second read interval “Read 2” that includes sequencing operations to generate second reads of the sample during another time T2B. During sequencing run 172A, a first primary analysis 100A processes data to generate the first and second reads. Primary analysis 100A can include, for example, the processing of images to generate the sequence of nucleotides or bases of each of the reads. After conclusion of the first primary analysis 100A, secondary analysis 100B begins. In this example of FIG. 1A, secondary analysis 100B is performed using software resources of a nucleic acid sequencer and includes demultiplexing the reads generated during primary analysis 100A of the first sequencing run 172A, mapping and aligning the demultiplexed reads, and then variant calling-all during time T3. It is only after the

completion of secondary analysis that the next primary analysis **100C** can be performed by a nucleic acid sequencer. Accordingly, by employing conventional workflows using conventional secondary analysis software by the nucleic acid sequencer, it takes at least

$TSUM=T1+T2A+T2B+T3$ —in some cases, approximately 56-99 hours—after initiating a first primary analysis **100A** of a first sequencing run **172A** until a second primary analysis **100C** of a second sequencing run **172B** can be performed. Moreover, this results in periods of sequencer downtime, where the sequencer is not performing secondary analysis and consuming reagents, in some cases at least 30-48 hours, thus reducing instrument throughput, the number of nucleotides processed in a given time interval, and negatively impacting revenue streams from reagent sales.

(14) Conventional systems operate this way because conventional nucleic acid sequencers lack computational resources to run primary analysis and secondary analysis operations in parallel. Instead, software computing resources of the conventional nucleic acid sequencers are dedicated to sequencing operations during primary analysis and then these same computing resources are dedicated to demultiplexing, mapping, aligning, and variant calling operations during secondary analysis. In some implementations, demultiplexing can include sorting operations.

(15) The present disclosure addresses these problems by offloading aspects of secondary analysis operations to a programmable logic unit having hardwired digital logic configured to perform one or more secondary analysis operations using hardware circuits. This drastically reduces the time- $T3$ -required to perform secondary analysis operations. Moreover, the present disclosure parallelizes sequencing operations such as clustering, primary analysis, other sequencing operations, or a combination thereof, and secondary analysis as described herein to reduce overall processing time $TSUM$ from the start of first sequencing run **172A** to the start of second sequencing run **172B** by modifying conventional nucleic acid sequencing devices to perform the parallelized workflow operations described herein.

(16) Multiple other advantages are gained using the techniques of the present disclosure. First, the present disclosure can be used to conserve reagents used by a nucleic acid sequencer during sequencing runs. For example, by beginning secondary analysis operations during a sequencing run and completing at least a portion of the secondary analysis operations before sequencing is complete, the present disclosure can generate statistics such as alignment statistics, demultiplexing statistics, or the like, and evaluate the generated statistics to gauge a quality of reads generated during the primary analysis. If the statistics indicate that the quality of the reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencer are poor, then primary analysis can be terminated, the inputs to the sequencer can be reconfigured, and another sequencing run using the nucleic acid sequencer can be restarted. Thus, this process can save at least a portion of the reagent that would have been expended to complete the entire first primary analysis sequencing run by stopping the primary analysis sequencing run without using all of the reagent to complete a low quality sequencing run.

(17) Second, the parallelized workflows of the present disclosure can enable tertiary analysis to begin sooner than conventional systems, thereby allowing certain diagnosis and treatments to be identified faster. For example, conventional workflows using conventional computing architectures can, in some cases, take up to a $TSUM$ =approximately 56-99 hours before beginning tertiary analysis. However, in some implementations of the present disclosure, tertiary analysis can be started in as little as 2-12 hours or a few hours after sequencing is complete. In some instances, this can be particularly advantageous such as, e.g., providing a faster determination of whether symptoms of a patient are related to a virus or bacteria. However, multiple scenarios exist where determining a treatment in hours vs., in some cases, 3-4 days can provide a substantial benefit—e.g., enabling a patient an opportunity to be administered antibiotics (or other type of drug or treatment) before an infection (or other illness) causes irreversible damage.

(18) These and other advantages will become apparent from the features described in the present disclosure.

(19) FIG. 1B is a contextual diagram of an example of a system **100** for performing incremental

secondary analysis on one sample **105** using a secondary analysis unit **140** located within a nucleic acid sequencer. The system **100** includes a nucleic acid sequencer **110**, one or more flow cells **120**, one or more secondary analysis units **140**, one or more processing units **150**, and one or more memories **160**. In the example of FIG. **1B**, the secondary analysis unit **140** is located within the sequencer **110**. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, the secondary analysis unit **140** can be located within one or more remote computers that are communicatively coupled to the sequencer **110** using one or more wired or wireless networks such as a LAN, a WAN, a cellular network, the Internet, or any combination thereof. The secondary analysis unit **140** can include the memory **140**, the programmable circuit **142**, the processing unit **150**, the memory **160**, or any combination thereof. For purposes of this specification, secondary analysis can include mapping operations, aligning operations, variant calling operations, or any subset or combination thereof. In some implementations, the processing unit **150**, the memory **160**, or both, may be used by the nucleic acid sequencer to perform other operations that are not related to secondary analysis.

(20) The one or more processing units **150** of the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can include one or more processors configured to execute software instructions to realize functionality defined by the software instructions. For example, the one or more processing units **150** can obtain and execute software instructions defining a demultiplexing unit **162** stored in the memory **160** to realize the functionality of the demultiplexing unit **162**. The one or more processing units **150** can include one or more central processing units (CPUs), one or more graphical processing units (GPUs), or any combination thereof.

(21) The term “unit” is used in this specification to describe a software module, a hardware module, or a combination of both, that is used to perform a specified function. A determination of whether a particular “unit” described herein is hardware, software, or a combination of both, can be made based on the context of its use. For example, a “mapping and aligning unit” **142a** resident in a programmable circuit **142** is a hardware unit whose functionality is realized by hardwired digital logic gates or hardwired digital logic blocks. By way of another example, a “demultiplexing unit” **162** resident in a memory **160** is a software unit whose functionality is realized by processing unit **150** executing software instructions defining the “demultiplexing unit” **162**. By way of another example, the “processing unit” **150** is a hardware device that realizes functionality by processing software instructions, and thus functionality of the “processing unit” **150** is a combination of hardware and software. Similarly, the “secondary analysis unit” **140** can include a combination of hardware and software that is used to interact with the hardwired programmable circuit **142a**.

(22) The nucleic acid sequencer **110** is a device that is configured to perform sequencing operations such as primary analysis. Primary analysis can include receiving, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, a biological sample **105** such as a blood sample, tissue sample, or sputum, and generating, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, output data such as one or more reads **130-1**, **130-2**, **130-3**, **130-4**, **132-1**, **132-2**, **132-3**, **132-4**, **134-1**, **134-2**, **134-3**, **134-4** that each represent an order of nucleotides of a nucleic acid sequence of the received biological sample. Sequencing, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, can be performed in multiple read intervals, with a first read interval “Read **1**” generating one or more first reads representing an order of nucleotides from a first portion, or end, of a nucleic acid sequence fragment (or strand) that has been clonally amplified into a clonal grouping of template nucleic acid fragments bound to a flowcell **120** and a second read interval “Read **2**” generating one or more second reads respectively representing an order of nucleotides from a second portion, for example the other end, of the nucleic acid sequence fragment that has been clonally amplified into a clonal grouping of template nucleic acid fragments bound to a flowcell **120**. Respective clonal groupings of template nucleic acid fragments bound to the flowcell **120** can be referred to herein as clusters such as cluster **1** **122-1**, cluster **2** **122-2**, cluster **3** **122-3**, cluster **4** **122-4**, cluster **5** **122-5**, cluster **N** **122-N**.

(23) As a result, during each read interval, a single read will be generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device **110** for each end of the nucleic acid fragment clonally amplified in a respective

cluster. That is, the first read interval of a sequencing cycle will produce “Read 1” and the second read interval of a sequencing cycle will produce “Read 2.” In some implementations, the nucleic acid sequence may sequence multiple clones of the nucleic acid fragment within the same cluster for imaging and determining or identifying the read sequence.

(24) Thus, each read represents a portion of a particular nucleic acid sequence fragment. For example, assuming a short nucleic acid sequence fragment of approximately 600 nucleotides, a first read may represent **150** ordered nucleotides for the first end of the nucleic acid sequence fragment and a second read may represent **150** ordered nucleotides of the other end of the nucleic acid sequence fragment. These numbers, however, are merely examples and a nucleic acid sequencer **110** can be configured in a manner consistent with the spirit and scope of the present disclosure that generates short nucleic acid sequences and respective reads of different lengths than those mentioned here. A simple version of this concept is depicted with reference to FIGS. **1B**, **3**, and **5** to convey the principles of the present disclosure to a skilled artisan. Specifically, these figures depict reads, generated by a nucleic acid sequencer **110**, of respective ends of clustered nucleic acid sequence fragments whose nucleic acid template was bound to a flow cell **120** and clonally amplified.

(25) In some implementations, the biological sample can include a DNA sample and the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can process DNA. In such implementations, the order of sequenced nucleotides in a read **130-1**, **130-2**, **130-3**, **130-4**, **132-1**, **132-2**, **132-3**, **132-4**, **134-1**, **134-2**, **134-3**, **134-4** generated by the nucleic acid sequencer can include one or more of guanine (G), cytosine (C), adenine (A), and thymine (T) in any combination. In other implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can process RNA, and the biological sample can include an RNA sample. In such RNA implementations, the order of sequenced nucleotides in a read generated by the nucleic acid sequencer can include one or more of G, C, A, and uracil (U) in any combination. Accordingly, though the example of FIG. **1B** describes processing of a read comprised of G, C, A, and T that is based on a DNA sample, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, other implementations can process reads comprised of C, G, A, and U that are based on an RNA sample.

(26) However, RNA sequencing does not require use of an RNA sequencer. For example, in some implementations nucleic acid sequencer **110** can be a DNA sequencer that sequences a sample and generated reads having one or more of G, C, A, and T. Then, in such implementations, nucleic acid sequencer **110** can transcribe the generated reads into cDNA to represent the RNA of the sequenced sample. In such implementations, the reads would be represented using bases that include G, C, A, and uracil (U) in any combination.

(27) In some implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can include a next generation sequencer (NGS) that is configured to generate sequence reads such as reads **130-1**, **130-2**, **130-3**, **130-4**, **132-1**, **132-2**, **132-3**, **132-4**, **134-1**, **134-2**, **134-3**, **134-4** for a given sample in a manner that achieves ultra-high throughput, scalability, and speed through the use of massively parallel sequencing technology. The NGS enables rapid sequencing of whole genomes, the ability to zoom into deeply sequenced target regions, utilize RNA sequencing (RNA-Seq) to discover novel RNA variants and splice sites, or quantify mRNAs for gene expression analysis, analysis of epigenetic factors such as genome-wide DNA methylation and DNA-protein interactions, sequencing of cancer samples to study rare somatic variants and tumor subclones, and studying of microbial diversity in humans or in the environment.

(28) The process of generating the nucleic acid sequencing reads includes stages of sample preparation, cluster generation, and sequencing. The first stage includes sample preparation, which includes adding adapter sequences to the end of each DNA fragment. Through reduced cycle amplification, additional motifs are introduced such as any necessary indices that can be used to identify the sample from which the reads are derived and regions complimentary to flow cell **120** oligos. One or more examples of sample preparation on a solid support are described in U.S. Pat. No. 9,683,230, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety. The second stage includes

clustering, where each DNA fragment is isothermally amplified, for example, using an amplification reagent. One or more examples of isothermal amplification of nucleic acids on a solid support are described in more detail in U.S. Pat. No. 7,972,820, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety. The flow cell **120** can include a glass slide with multiple lanes, with each lane including a lawn of two types of oligos. Hybridization is enabled by the first of two types of oligos to attach to its complementary oligos on the surface of the flow cell. A polymerase creates a complement of the hybridized fragment. The DNA fragments can be clonally amplified using a technique such as bridge amplification. In the implementation of system **100** and workflow **170B**, the clustering stages occur during time **T1** of workflow **170B**. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, in some implementations, clustering may begin and be performed before time **T1**, performed off instrument, or both. In such implementations, time **T1** can be removed from run time calculations and a sequencing run can begin at, e.g., **T2A**. Such pre-**T1** and/or off instrument clustering can be implemented in systems **100** of FIG. 1, system **300** of FIG. 3, system **500** of FIG. 5, system **700** of FIG. 7, or any other implementation of the present disclosure. After bridge amplifications, reverse fragments are cleaved off, leaving only the forward fragments.

(29) The third stage includes performance of sequencing operations during times **T2A** and **T2B** by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**. During time **T2A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** performs **X** cycles of sequencing operations for a first read interval “Read **1**” to generate a first read that corresponds to a first end of each respective nucleic acid sequence fragment clonally amplified in respective clusters **122-1**, **122-2**, **122-3**, **122-4**, **122-5**, **122-N**, where **X** and **N** can be any positive integer greater than zero. The first read of each DNA cluster includes a string of base calls corresponding to a portion of respective DNA associated with a particular cluster. For example the read **130-1** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **1 122-1**, the read **130-3** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **2 122-2**, the read **132-1** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **3 122-3**, the read **132-3** includes a string of bases calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **4 122-4**, the read **134-1** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **5 122-5**, and the read **134-3** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a first end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **N 122-N**. Each base call corresponds to or represents a nucleotide. These reads can be generated using a sequencing process such as sequencing by synthesis. Data representing the reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, and **134-3** can be output to a memory **160** of the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, input to memory **144** of the secondary analysis unit **140**, or both.

(30) In the implementation of system **100** and FIG. 1B, these first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, and **134-3** sequenced during time **T2A** of a first read interval of workflow **170B** represent a number of nucleotides on the first end of a DNA fragment associated with each cluster. For example, in some implementations a DNA fragment sequenced by nucleic acid sequencer **110** may include 600 nucleotides. The first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, and **134-3** cluster may represent, e.g., a first 150 nucleotides of a first end of the **600** nucleotide DNA fragment amplified in the respective cluster. Each read interval is a massively parallel process that sequences hundreds of millions of clusters of DNA fragments simultaneously. Once the first read interval is completed at the end of **T2A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can initiate a second read interval during time **T2B** that sequences the opposite end of each DNA fragment in each cluster to generate second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**. By way of example the read **130-2** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **1 122-1**, the read **130-4** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **2 122-2**, the read **132-2** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **3 122-3**, the read **132-4** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid

fragment associated with cluster **4 122-4**, the read **134-2** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **5 122-5**, and the read **134-4** includes a string of base calls corresponding to a second end of the nucleic acid fragment associated with cluster **N 122-N**. In this implementation of system **100** and FIG. **1**, the second read interval begins at approximately $\text{Time}=\text{T1}+\text{T2A}$ of workflow **170B**.

(31) In conventional systems, as described with reference to FIG. **1A**, secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, and **134-3** would not occur until after the end of the second read interval “Read 2” at the end of $\text{Time}=\text{T1}+\text{T2A}+\text{T2B}$. However, the system **100** of FIG. **1B** as described by the present disclosure is configured to initiate secondary analysis operations of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** at $\text{Time}=\text{T1}+\text{T2A}$, with the secondary analysis of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** beginning, and occurring, during the second read interval “Read 2” while the nucleic acid sequencer **110** is performing sequencing operations of the second read interval “Read 2” to generate the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**.

(32) The system **100** achieves this parallel processing advantage by offloading secondary analysis operations of the first reads to the secondary analysis unit's **140** programmable circuit **142a**. Offloading secondary analysis operations to the secondary analysis unit **140** frees up processing unit **150**, memory **160**, or both, of the nucleic acid sequencer **110** to continue performance of primary analysis operations of the second read interval “Read 2” to generate second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** by sequencing the opposite end of the DNA cluster while secondary analysis of one or more of the first reads is being performed. Accordingly, the present disclosure enables sequencing operations such as primary analysis to be done in parallel with one or more secondary analysis operations.

(33) The secondary analysis unit **140** includes a programmable circuit **142** that can be dynamically configured to include one or more secondary analysis operational units such as a mapping and aligning unit **142a** to perform one or more secondary analysis operations. Dynamically configuring the programmable circuit **142** to include a secondary analysis operational unit such as a mapping and aligning unit **142a** can include, for example, providing one or more instructions to the programmable circuit **142** that causes the programmable circuit **142** to arrange hardware logic gates of the programmable circuit **142** into a hardwired digital logic configuration that is configured to realize functionality, in hardware logic, of the mapping and aligning unit **142a**. The hardware logic gates of the programmable circuit **142** may be realized using compiled hardware description language code or the like. Initial configurations of the programmable circuit **142** and subsequent reconfiguration of the programmable circuit **142** can be initiated by execution of software triggers that are satisfied by the nucleic acid sequencer **110** or other computer hosting the programmable circuit **142**. For example, in the implementation of system **100** of FIG. **1B**, at the end of Read **1** interval cycle, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** or other computer hosting the programmable circuit **142** can execute software instructions that trigger reconfiguration of the programmable circuit to performing mapping and aligning operations. Such execution of the aforementioned software triggers can, for example, cause loading of compiled hardware description language code into a memory of the programmable circuit **142** that can be executed by a programmable circuit control and cause reconfiguration of the programmable circuit **142** logic gates. Configured functionality of the mapping and aligning unit **142a** can include obtaining one or more reads such as first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3**, mapping the obtained first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** to one or more reference sequence locations, and then aligning the mapped first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** to the one or more reference sequence locations. A reference sequence can include an organized series of nucleotides corresponding to a known genome.

(34) Arranging hardware logic gates of the programmable circuit **142**, responsive to the one or more instructions, can include configuring logic gates such as AND gates, OR gates, NOR gates,

XOR gates, or any combination thereof, to execute digital logic functions of a mapping and aligning unit **142a**. Examples of use of a programmable logic circuit such as an FPGA to perform functions of mapping and aligning unit are described in more detail, for example, by U.S. Pat. No. 9,679,104 or U.S. Pub. No. 2020/0372031, each of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety. Alternatively, or in addition, arranging hardware logic gates can include dynamically configured logic blocks comprising customizable hardware logic units to perform complex computing operations including addition, multiplication, comparisons, or the like. The precise arrangement of the hardware logic gates, logic blocks, or a combination thereof, is defined by the received instructions. The received instructions can include, or are derived from, compiled hardware description language (HDL) program code that was written by an entity and defines the schematic layout of the secondary analysis operational unit that is to be programmed. The HDL program code can include program code written in a language such a Very High Speed Integrated Circuit Hardware Description Language (VHDL), Verilog, or the like. The entity can include one or more human users that drafted the HDL program code, one or more artificially intelligent agents that generated the HDL program code, or a combination thereof.

(35) In some implementations, the programmable circuit **142** can include one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGA), complex programmable logic devices (CPLD), or a programmable logic arrays (PLA), or a combination thereof, that are dynamically configurable and reconfigurable, as needed, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110** to execute a particular workflow. For example, in some implementations, it may be desirable to use the programmable logic circuit **142** as a mapping and aligning unit **142a**, as described above. However, in other implementations, it may be desirable to use the programmable circuit **142** to perform variant calling functions or functions in support of variant calling such as a Hidden Markov Model (HMM) unit. In yet other implementations, the programmable circuit **142** can also be dynamically configured to support general computing tasks such as compression and decompression, as the hardware logic of the programmable circuit **142** is capable of performing these tasks, and the other tasks identified above, much faster than the performance of the same tasks using software instructions executed by one or more processing units **150**.

(36) Programmable circuits **142** are an example of one type of integrated circuit can provide the advantages of present disclosure described herein. However, other types of integrated circuits can be used as hardwired digital logic of the secondary analysis unit **140** that can offload secondary analysis of the nucleic acid sequencer **110** to free up resources of the nucleic acid sequencer **110** for primary analysis. For example, in some implementations, a secondary analysis unit **140** can be configured to use one or more Application-Specific Integrated Circuits (ASIC). Though not reprogrammable, one or more ASICs can be designed with custom hardware logic of one or more secondary analysis operational units such as a mapping and aligning unit, a variant calling unit, a variant calling computational support unit, or the like to accelerate and parallelize performance secondary analysis operations. In some implementations, use of the ASICs as the hardwired logic circuits of the secondary analysis unit **140** that realizes functionality of one or more secondary analysis operations units can be even faster than using a programmable circuit. Accordingly, a skilled artisan would understand that an ASIC could be used in place of the FPGA in any of the embodiments described herein.

(37) By way of example, in some implementations, the programmable logic circuit **142** can be implemented using an FPGA that be dynamically configured as a decompression unit to access data representing the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** received from the nucleic acid sequencer and decompress the data representing the first reads (e.g., if the reads received from the nucleic acid sequencer are compressed). The decompression unit can store decompressed reads stored in the memory **144** or **160**. In such implementations, the FPGA can then be dynamically reconfigured as a mapping and aligning unit **142a** to perform mapping and aligning of the decompressed first reads stored in the memory **144** or **160**. The mapping and aligning unit **142a**

can then store data representing the mapped and aligned reads in the memory **144** or **160**. Next, the FPGA can be dynamically reconfigured into variant calling unit or unit configured to perform functions in support of a software variant calling unit (e.g., HMM unit) and perform variant calling operations to generate output data that can be used by the sequencing system **100** to generate a Variant Calling Format (VCF) file based on the stored data representing the mapped and aligned reads. The high execution speed of these hardware modules executed using the FPGA can reduce secondary analysis of reads from 30 to 48 hours of conventional methods to being performed in a matter of minutes. Though a series of operations is described as including decompression, mapping and aligning, and variant calling operations is described, the present disclosure is not limited to performing all of those operations. Instead, the programmable circuit **142** can be dynamically configured to perform any operational unit in any order, as necessary, to parallelize secondary analysis offloaded from the nucleic acid sequencer **110**.

(38) With reference to the example of FIG. **1A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can configure the programmable circuit **142** of the secondary analysis unit **140** to include a mapping and alignment unit **142a**. The nucleic acid sequencer **110** can receive a sample **105** such as nucleic acid of an entity such as a human person, non-human animal, or plant. The nucleic acid sequencer **110** can prepare the sample **105** and perform cluster generation during time **T1** of the workflow **170B**. The nucleic acid sequencer **110** can perform sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis during a first read interval to generate first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** during a time **T2A** that occurs following time **T1**. At the end of time **T1+T2A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** completes sequencing of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** and begins sequencing of the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**.

(39) The nucleic acid sequencer **110** is configured to parallelize secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** with sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis of a second read interval to generate second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** during the time period **T2B**. The mapping and aligning unit **142a** can generate mapping and aligning results **149** and store the mapping and aligning results in the memory **160** of nucleic acid sequencer **110**, the memory **144**, some other memory that is accessible to the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, some other memory that is accessible to a user of the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, or a combination thereof. The results **149** can include data describing mapping and aligning statistics such as, for example, a Mapping Quality (MAPQ) score that provides an indication of mapping quality, an alignment score that provides an indication of alignment quality, or the like.

(40) In the example of FIG. **1A**, the ultrafast execution times of the mapping and aligning unit **142a** implemented using hardwired digital logic of the programmable circuit **142** enables the mapping and aligning unit **142a** to perform mapping and aligning of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** in a fraction of the time that is required, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, to perform the second read interval. For example, in some implementations, the programmable circuit **142** can perform mapping and aligning of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** in mere minutes while sequencing of the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** can take 12 to 24 hours. Accordingly, the mapping and aligning results **149** can be evaluated by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, a user of the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, or both, and a determination can be made, based on the quality of the mapping and alignment of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** as indicated by the mapping and alignment statistics whether the nucleic acid sequencer **110** should continue sequencing the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**.

(41) This determination as to whether sequencing of the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** should continue can be made automatically by the nucleic acids sequencer **110**, manually by a user of the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, or based on data describing a determination from both. By way of example, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can be configured to determine

whether mapping and aligning statistics such as alignment scores for the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, and **134-3** satisfy a predetermined threshold. If one or more alignment scores satisfy the predetermined threshold, then the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can continue sequencing the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**. Alternatively, if it is determined that the one or more alignment scores do not satisfy the predetermined threshold, then the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can terminate sequencing of the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**.

(42) By way of a different example, in some implementations, the mapping and aligning results **149** can be manually reviewed by a user of the nucleic acid sequencer **110**. In such instances, a user can determine whether the nucleic acid sequencer **110** is to continue sequencing the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** based on the quality of the alignment of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** as indicated by the alignment scores.

(43) By way of yet another example, determinations can be made by both the nucleic acid sequencer **110** and the user as to whether sequencing of the second reads should continue based on the quality of the alignment of first reads indicated by alignment scores indicated by the mapping and aligning results **149**. In such implementations, data describing the determinations of the nucleic acid sequencer **110** and the user can be obtained, and in some implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** will only terminate the second read interval if both the nucleic acid sequencer **110** and the user agree that the second read interval should be terminated.

(44) In yet other implementations, a weighted average of the two determinations can be computed to produce an aggregate score representing a determination of both the nucleic acid sequencer **110** and the user. In such implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** may only terminate if the aggregate score fails to satisfy a predetermined quality threshold. In yet other implementations, data representing the alignment statistics, data representing a user determination as to whether sequencing of a second read interval should continue, data representing one or more of the first reads, other data such as data representing features of the sample **105**, or a combination thereof, can be vectorized and input to an artificially intelligent agent such as a machine learning model that has been trained to determine whether a nucleic acid sequencer **110** should continue primary analysis of a second read interval. In such implementations, the machine learning model can be previously trained based on labeled training data tagged as “terminate second read interval” or “continue with second read interval,” or their respective equivalents. The labeled training data can include data representing the same input types that will be provided to the machine learning model at runtime. Such input types can include data representing the alignment statistics, data representing a user determination as to whether sequencing of a second read interval should continue, data representing one or more of the first reads, other data such as data representing features of the sample **105**, or a combination thereof.

(45) Using the mapping and aligning results **149** generated based on the mapping and aligning of the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** to one or more reference sequences enables the conservation of reagent used, by the nucleic acid sequencer **110**, during the second read interval to generate second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4**. For instance, poor alignment scores for the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** can indicate the existence of a number of problems such as a contaminated sample **105**, sequencing errors, a combination thereof, or the like. Accordingly, in such instances, rather than use reagents, which can be very expensive, to sequence the second reads during the second read interval and further delay the time it takes to begin running another round of primary analysis, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can be shut down, reconfigured, and then used to begin primary analysis of another sample in a fraction of the time it would have taken to let the nucleic acid sequencer **110** finish its low quality sequencing run. In some implementations, once a determination as been made that the quality of mapping and alignment of the first reads is satisfactory, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can discard the mapping and aligning results **149**. In other implementations, the mapping and alignment of the first reads

performed in parallel with the second read interval can be used as the mapping and alignment results for a final data run of the first reads.

(46) Continuing with the example of FIG. 1B, after it has determined that the mapping and alignment results are satisfactory, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can continue execution of the second read interval to generate the second reads. Once the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** are generated, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can instruct the secondary analysis unit **140** to begin its final secondary analysis data run. The final secondary analysis data run can include mapping and aligning the first reads **130-1**, **130-3**, **132-1**, **132-3**, **134-1**, **134-3** and the second reads **130-2**, **130-4**, **132-2**, **132-4**, **134-2**, **134-4** using the secondary analysis unit **140**. Because these secondary analysis operations are implemented using the programmable circuit **142a**, these secondary analysis operations can be performed in parallel with a second sequencing run and in a fraction of the time required to perform the second sequencing run.

(47) This provides an advantage over conventional systems of being able to move onto subsequent sequencing runs while secondary analysis of the reads of a preceding sequencing run is being performed. That is, where conventional nucleic acid sequencers would have needed to wait approx. 24-48 hours after completion of a first sequencing run before commencing a second sequencing run, as shown in FIG. 1A, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can use the mapping and aligning unit **142a** implemented in the programmable circuit **142** to parallelize secondary analysis of reads of the first sequencing run with performance of a second sequencing run. Thus, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** of FIG. 1B can be used to perform more sequencing runs in shorter periods of time than conventional systems that use the system and workflow described by FIG. 1A. Accordingly, parallelizing sequencing runs and secondary analysis by offloading secondary analysis computing tasks to the programmable circuit **142** of the secondary analysis unit **140** can create an increase in revenue from additional reagent sales.

(48) In some implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **110** can also have software programs such as a demultiplexing unit **162** and a variant calling unit **164** stored in memory **160**. One or more processors **150** of the nucleic acid sequencer can process software instructions for these units in order to realize the functionality of these units. For example, in some implementations, DNA fragments of multiple samples may be sequenced at the same time using the nucleic acid sequencer **110**. In such instances, the demultiplexing unit **162** can be used to implement demultiplexing techniques that organize the reads based on an index such as a barcode that has been added to each of the generated reads and identify the sample that is associated with each read. By way of another example, the processor **150** can be used to execute the variant calling unit **164** which can analyze mapped and aligned reads to identify the occurrence of any variants such as single nucleotide polymorphisms (SNPs), insertions/deletions (indels), structural variations, or the like. In some implementations, the programmable circuit **142** can be dynamically reconfigured to aid variant calling processing. For example the programmable circuit **142** can be dynamically reconfigured to include an HMM unit that can be used to perform probability calculations as to the likely occurrence of a variant at one or more reference locations of mapped and aligned reads. In some implementations, variant calling unit **164** can be configured to perform variant calling operations of mapped and aligned reads from a Read **1** interval in parallel with sequencing operations of a second sequencing run.

(49) The example of FIG. 1B describes an example having reads with 8 nucleotides. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, this simple example is presented to explain features of the present disclosure in a manner that is easy to understand. In practice, DNA fragments of the present disclosure may each have, in some implementations, e.g., up to 600 nucleotides, up to 1000 nucleotides, or more, and each read of the fragment may have, e.g., 50 nucleotides, 75 nucleotides, 150 nucleotides, 200 nucleotides, 300 nucleotides, 500 nucleotides, or more, from each end of the DNA fragment. However, implementations of the present disclosure can be employed that have different length DNA fragments and reads of different lengths. Likewise, nothing in FIG. 1B or any

other figure should be interpreted as limiting a number of clusters of fragments. For example, a nucleic acid sequencer **110** may perform massively parallel sequencing, with millions of clusters of multiple fragments being sequenced simultaneously.

(50) FIG. 2 is a flowchart of an example of a process **200** for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 1B. In general, the process **200** includes obtaining first data representing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval (**210**), obtaining second data representing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval (**220**), while the second data is being obtained in stage **220** (I) performing one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data representing the plurality of first reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencer and (II) storing the results of the secondary analysis of the first plurality of reads (**230**), and, thereafter, performing secondary analysis of the obtained second data representing the second plurality of reads to the reference data. For convenience, these stages will be described in more detail below as being performed by a sequencing system such as system **100** of FIG. 1B.

(51) A sequencing system can begin execution of the process **200** by obtaining **210** first data representing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval. Obtaining the first data can include storing the first data representing the plurality of first reads in a memory device such as a memory device of a secondary analysis unit after the first data is generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof. Each read of the plurality of first reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a first end of a nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid sequencing device can include any nucleic acid sequencing device including a sequencer capable of sequencing either DNA or RNA.

(52) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **200** by obtaining **220** second data representing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval. Obtaining the second data can include storing the second data representing the plurality of second reads in a memory of a secondary analysis unit after the second data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof. In some implementation, at least a portion of the second data is obtained while another portion of the second data is being generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. Each read of the plurality of second reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a second end of the nucleic acid fragment that is opposite to the first end of the nucleic acid fragment.

(53) While the sequencing system is obtaining the second data at stage **220**, the sequencing system can perform at stage **230** one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data representing the plurality of first reads. In some implementations, performing one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data representing the plurality of first reads can include (i) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data to a mapping and aligning unit to align the first data representing the plurality of first reads to a reference sequence, (ii) aligning, using the mapping and aligning unit, the first data representing the plurality of first reads to a reference sequence, (iii) receiving, from the mapping and aligning unit, alignment results, and (iv) storing the received alignment results of the alignment of the first data representing the plurality of first reads to the

reference sequence before completion of the obtaining second data at stage **204**. The alignment results can include alignment statistics that describe a quality of the alignment of the first data representing the first plurality of reads to a reference sequence. The alignment statistics can include, for example, one or more of a MAPQ score, an alignment score, or the like. In other implementations, the alignment results can include mapped and aligned reads that can be provided as an input to a variant caller for a determination of potential variants.

(54) In some implementations, output data describing the alignment results can be provided for review by one or more human users. For example, output data describing the alignment results can be output on a display, e.g., coupled to the nucleic acid sequencing device or provided in another room or building. Alternatively, or in addition, output data describing the alignment results can be output using a printer communicatively coupled, e.g., directly or indirectly, to the nucleic acid sequencing device to print a report describing the alignment results.

(55) In some implementations, at least a portion of the mapping and aligning unit is implemented in an integrated circuit such as programmable circuit or ASIC installed in the nucleic acid sequencing device. For example, the programmable circuit or ASIC may implement table look-up functions, a Smith-Waterman algorithm, or quality score determination. However, in other implementations, one or more operations of the mapping and aligning unit may be performed in software executed by the nucleic acid sequencing device. For example, controlling the programmable circuit and the sorting of alignment results may be implemented in software. In yet other implementations, the mapping and aligning unit may be implemented in a programmable circuit, ASIC, executable software, or a combination thereof, in one or more remote computers that is communicatively coupled to the nucleic acid sequencing device using one or more networks. In such implementations, data representing reads, alignment results, and the like can be communicated between the nucleic acid sequencing device and the one or more remote computers hosting the mapping and aligning unit using one or more networks.

(56) The sequencing system, other processing system, or one or more human users can evaluate the alignments results while the second data is being obtained in stage **220**. For example, the alignment results can be evaluated to determine whether the alignment is of sufficient quality to continue obtaining second data in stage **220**. In some implementations, if the alignment results for the first plurality of reads fail to satisfy a predetermined threshold, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be instructed to stop obtaining the second data in stage **220**. Alternatively, if it is determined that the alignment results for the first plurality of reads satisfies the predetermined threshold, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be permitted to continue obtaining the second data in stage **220**.

(57) In other implementations, the mapped and aligned first reads can be evaluated for the detection of potential variants between the mapped and aligned first reads and one or more reference sequences while the second data is being obtained at stage **220**. Such implementations can enable tertiary analysis of the mapped and aligned first reads to be achieved quicker than conventional methods, which would prohibit the beginning of tertiary analysis until after completion of both the first read interval and the second read interval. Thus, initial diagnosis can be obtained to start treatment as much as 12-24 hours, or more, earlier by not having to wait for the second read interval to complete before proceeding to tertiary analysis.

(58) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **200** by instructing at stage **240** the performance of secondary analysis operations on the second data, e.g., instructing the mapping and aligning unit to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads to the reference sequence. In some implementations, the sequencing system **200** may always proceed to stage **240**. Such implementations still provide technical advantages of expediting tertiary analysis and a reduction in the downtime of the nucleic acid sequencing device. However, in other implementations, execution of the process **200** may only continue with instructing the mapping and aligning unit to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads to the reference sequence if the received alignment results describing the quality of the alignment of the

first data representing the plurality of first reads is determined to satisfy a predetermined quality threshold.

(59) In some implementations, the sequencing system can rely on the secondary analysis results of mapping and aligning, variant calling, or both, of the first data performed at stage **220** while the second data was being obtained. In other implementations, these initial secondary analysis results related to the first data performed at stage **230** can be discarded after they are evaluated to determine quality of the first read interval. In such instances, the sequencing system can initiate a second iteration of the secondary analysis of the first data either before or after secondary analysis of the second data is performed at stage **240**.

(60) FIG. **3** is a contextual diagram of an example of a system **300** for performing incremental secondary analysis of one or more samples using a secondary analysis unit **340** that is located remote from the nucleic acid sequencer **310**. The system **300** is generally the same as system **100** described with reference to FIG. **1B** with a few changes. One change is that the secondary analysis unit **340** is located in one or more computers **320** that are remote from the nucleic acid sequencer **310**. For any reference numeral of FIG. **3** not explicitly mentioned, the component identified by the reference numeral has the same features as its corresponding feature in FIG. **1**. For example, respective clusters **322-1**, **322-2**, **322-3**, **322-4**, **322-5**, **322-N** have the same meaning as clusters **122-1**, **122-2**, **122-3**, **122-4**, **122-5**, **122-N**, respectively, of FIG. **1**, unless additional or different features are described with reference to FIG. **3**.

(61) Another difference between the example of FIG. **3** and the example of FIG. **1B** is that in the example of FIG. **3**, multiple samples are processed. As a result, the reads produced by the nucleic acid sequencer **310** in system **300** have an index that is generated for each read. This index is represented in FIG. **3** by the labels **S1**, **S2**, and **S3** that are attached to each read. In this example, **S1**, **S2**, **S3** are strings used to identify reads generated based on a first sample, second sample, or third sample respectively. Though the indexes are described here using a term **S1**, **S2**, **S3**, the present disclosure is not limited to use of text strings as a sample identifier, as these terms are being used as examples to illustrate the concept of an index. Instead, in some implementations, a barcode, or other data, may be used as a sample identifier of a read. In some implementations, the sample identifier can be generated by adding synthetic nucleotides representing the index to each generated read.

(62) With reference to the example of FIG. **3**, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** or remote computer **320** can configure the programmable circuit **342** of the secondary analysis unit **340** to include a mapping and alignment unit **342a**. The nucleic acid sequencer **310** can receive multiple samples **105**, **106**, **107**. The samples **105**, **106**, **107** can include, for example, nucleic acid samples from different entities. The different entities can be different persons, different animals, different plants, or the like. The nucleic acid sequencer **310** can prepare the samples **105**, **106**, **107** and perform cluster generation during time **T1** of the workflow **370**. The nucleic acid sequencer **310** can perform sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis of a first read interval to generate first reads **330-1**, **330-3**, **332-1**, **332-3**, **334-1**, **334-3** during a time **T2A** that occurs following time **T1**. At the end of time **T1+T2A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** completes sequencing of the first reads **330-1**, **330-3**, **332-1**, **332-3**, **334-1**, **334-3** and begins generating indexes for the first reads generated during the first read interval during time **T3A**. At the end of time **T1+T2A+T3A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** completes index generation for the first read cycle and begins generating indexes for the second reads that will be generated during the second read interval during time **T3B**. At the end of time **T1+T2A+T3A+T3B**, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** begins sequencing of the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4**.

(63) The nucleic acid sequencer **310** is configured to parallelize secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning of the first reads **330-1**, **330-3**, **332-1**, **332-3**, **334-1**, **334-3** while the nucleic acid sequencer **310** performs sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis of a second read interval to generate second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** during the

time period T2B. This process is similar to that described with reference to the example of FIG. 1B. However, in the example of FIG. 3, multiple samples have been sequenced. Accordingly, the plurality of first reads need to be demultiplexed into groups based on the indexes of each read before proceeding with other secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning and variant calling. Once the plurality of first reads are demultiplexed, one or more secondary analysis operations can be performed on the demultiplexed groups of first reads. In some implementations, the system 300 can generate demultiplexing statistics based on the demultiplexing operations and the stored statistics can be evaluated to determine the quality of sequenced reads.

(64) In the example of FIG. 3, secondary analysis of the first reads cannot begin until the end of time $T1+T2A+T3A+T3B$, because organization of the first reads into demultiplexed groups cannot occur until indexing operations during times T3A and T3B are complete. Once the second index is completed at the end of Time $T1+T2A+T3A+T3B$, the nucleic acid sequencer 310 can provide the plurality of first reads to the remote computer 320 over the network 112. The remote compute 320 can receive the plurality of first reads and store the plurality of first reads in the memory 344.

While the nucleic acid sequencer 310 is performing a second read interval during time T2B, the secondary analysis unit 340 can use the processing unit 350 to access the plurality of first reads in the memory 344 and use the demultiplexing unit 362 to demultiplex the plurality of first reads 330-1, 330-3, 332-1, 332-3, 334-1, 334-3 into groups based on the indexes or sample identifier, of each read. Demultiplexing can be achieved using demultiplexing operations to organize the first reads based on the index. The demultiplexed first reads can be stored in the memory 344. The mapping and aligning unit 342a can then access the reads stored in the memory 344 and perform mapping and aligning operations on the demultiplexed first reads during the second read interval.

(65) The secondary analysis unit 340 can generate statistics that can be used to evaluate the quality of the reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencer. In some implementations, the secondary analysis unit can generate demultiplexing statistics based on the demultiplexing operations. The mapping and aligning unit 342a can generate mapping and aligning results and statistics for each group of first reads stored in the memory 344. The mapping and aligning unit 342a can store results 359 in memory 360 or provide results 359 back to the nucleic acid sequencer 310.

(66) The results 359 can include demultiplexing statistics, mapping and aligning results, mapping and aligning statistics, variant calling statistics, or any combination thereof. The demultiplexing statistics can include a number of reads corresponding to each sample identifier. The mapping and aligning results can include data representing one or more mapped reads to a reference sequence. The mapping and aligning statistics can include data describing, for example, a MAPQ score that provides an indication of mapping quality, an alignment score that provides an indication of alignment quality, or the like. The nucleic acid sequencer 310 can receive the results 359 and store the received results in the memory 160.

(67) In the example of FIG. 3, the ultrafast execution times of the mapping and aligning unit 342a implemented using hardwired logic of the programmable circuit 342 enables the mapping and aligning unit 342a to perform mapping and aligning of the respective demultiplexed groups of first reads 330-1, 330-3, 332-1, 332-3, 334-1, 334-3 in a fraction of the time that is required, by the nucleic acid sequencer 310, to perform the second read interval. For example, in some implementations, the programmable circuit 342a can perform mapping and aligning of the demultiplexed groups of first reads 330-1, 330-3, 332-1, 332-3, 334-1, 334-3 in mere minutes while sequencing of the second reads 330-2, 330-4, 332-2, 332-4, 334-2, 334-4 during the second read interval can take 12 to 24 hours. Accordingly, the results 359 can be evaluated by the nucleic acid sequencer 310, the remote computer 320, a user of the nucleic acid sequencer 310, or remote computer 320, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, and a determination can be made, based on the quality of the demultiplexing of the first reads 330-1, 330-3, 332-1, 332-3, 334-1, 334-3, the quality of the mapping and alignment of the demultiplexed groups of first reads 330-1, 330-3, 332-1, 332-3, 334-1, 334-3, or both, whether the nucleic acid

sequencer **310** should continue sequencing operations during the second read interval to generate the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4**.

(68) A determination as to whether sequencing operations during the second read interval to generate the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** should continue can be made automatically by the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, manually by a user of the nucleic acid sequencer, automatically by an artificially intelligent agent or model, or based on data describing a determination from a combination thereof, as described with reference to the example of FIG. **1B**. Alternatively, or in addition, the remote computer **320**, a user of computer **320**, or an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, can determine, based on the results **359**, whether or not sequencing during the second read interval to generate the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** should continue. Such analysis of the results **359** can be evaluated by the remote computer **320**, a user of the remote computer **320**, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, in the same manner as described with reference to the evaluation of results **149** by the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, user of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, or an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, in the description of FIG. **1B**. In the case of an artificially intelligent agent or model, the artificially intelligent model can also be trained on input data types that include demultiplexing characteristics in addition to the other input data types described in the description of FIG. **1B**.

(69) In some implementations, the demultiplexing statistics can be evaluated separately from, or in conjunction with, the mapping and aligning statistics to determine a quality of the reads being generated by the nucleic acid sequencer **310**. For example, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** or remote computer **320** can store data representing an expected number of reads for each respective sample identifier. The nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the remote computer **320**, a user, an artificially intelligent agent, or a combination thereof, can then determine whether the demultiplexing statistics include a number of reads corresponding to each sample identifier that is within a threshold amount of error of the expected number of reads for each sample identifier. If the demultiplexing statistics are within the threshold amount of error of the expected number of reads for each sample identifier, the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, remote computer **320**, a human user, an artificially intelligent agent, or a combination thereof, can determine that the sequencing operations should continue. Alternatively, if it is determined that the demultiplexing statistics are not within a threshold amount of error of the expected number of reads for each sample identifier, then the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, remote computer **320**, a user, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, can determine that the sequencing run should be terminated.

(70) In some implementations, it may not be necessary for the results **359** to be transmitted back to the nucleic acid sequencer **310** from the remote computer **320**. Instead, the remote computer **320**, a user of remote computer **320**, or an artificially intelligent agent or model, can transmit data back to the nucleic acid sequencer **310** indicating whether or not the nucleic acid sequencer **310** should continue generation of the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** based on the computer **320**'s analysis, a user of computer **320**'s analysis, or an artificially intelligent agent or model's analysis of the results **359**. The nucleic acid sequencer can then determine whether to continue or termination the second read interval based on the data received from the remote computer **320** without actually receiving the results **359**.

(71) In yet another implementation, the nucleic acid sequencer can also consider multiple determinations, similar to that described with reference to FIG. **1B**. For example, in some implementations, data describing the determination of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the user of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the remote computer **320**, a user of remote computer **320**, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or any combination thereof, can be obtained, and in such implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** will only terminate the second read interval if the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the user of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the remote computer **320**, a user of the remote computer **320**, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or any combination

thereof, agree that the second read interval should be terminated. In other implementations, an aggregate score can be generated based on weighted average of the determinations of one or more of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the user of the nucleic acid sequencer **310**, the remote computer **320**, a user of the remote computer **320**, an artificially intelligent agent, or any combination thereof, and then determined, based on the aggregate score, whether the second read interval should be terminated. In such implementations the second read interval may be terminated if the aggregated score falls below a predetermined threshold. Alternatively, the second read interval may be continued if the aggregated score falls above the predetermined threshold.

(72) Using these techniques, the system **300** of FIG. **3** provides similar technological advantages described with reference to FIG. **1B**. That is, the system **300** can conserve reagents used to generate second reads if the results **359** indicate that the alignment of the first reads is a low quality alignment. Once a determination has been made that the quality of demultiplexing statistics, mapping and aligning results, mapping and alignment statistics, or combination thereof, is satisfactory, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** can discard the results **359**. In other implementations, the mapping and alignment of the first reads performed in parallel with the second read can be used as the mapping and alignment of the first reads for the final data run.

(73) Continuing with the example of FIG. **3**, after a determination that the results **359** are satisfactory, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** can continue execution of the second reads. Once the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** are generated, the nucleic acid sequencer **310** can transmit instructions to the remote computer **320** using the network **112** that instruct the secondary analysis unit **340** to begin its final secondary analysis data run. The final data run can include demultiplexing the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** into organized groups of second reads based on the sample identifiers of each second read and then mapping and aligning the second reads **330-2**, **330-4**, **332-2**, **332-4**, **334-2**, **334-4** using the secondary analysis unit **340**. In some implementations, if the mapping and aligning results of the organized first set of reads has been discarded, the final data run can perform mapping and aligning operations on both the first reads and the second reads. Because these operations are implemented using the programmable circuit **342a**, these operations can be performed in parallel with the second sequencing run **374** and in a fraction of the time required to perform the second sequencing run **374**. This provides the advantage over conventional systems of being able to continue subsequent sequencing runs while secondary analysis of the preceding sequencing run **372** is being performed, thereby reducing sequencer downtime that occurs in conventional systems shown in FIG. **1A**.

(74) In addition to demultiplexing and mapping and aligning, the secondary analysis unit **340** can also perform variant calling operations. By way of example, the processing unit **350** can be used to execute the variant calling unit **364** which can analyze mapped and aligned reads to identify the occurrence of any variants such as single nucleotide polymorphisms (SNPs), insertions/deletions (indels), structural variations, or the like. In some implementations, the programmable circuit **342** can be dynamically reconfigured, for example by the remote computer **320**, to aid variant calling processing. For example the programmable circuit **342** can be dynamically reconfigured to include an HMM unit that can be used to perform probability calculations as to the likely occurrence of a variant at one or more reference locations of mapped and aligned reads. Examples of use of a programmable circuit such an FPGA to perform variant calling operations are described in more detail in, for example, U.S. Pub. No. 2016/0180019, U.S. Pub. No. 2016/0306922, and U.S. Pub. No. 2019-0259468, the entire contents of each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

(75) The example of FIG. **3** describes an example having reads with 8 nucleotides and 3 samples. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, this simple example is being presented to explain features of the present disclosure in a manner that is easy to understand. In practice, a DNA fragments of the present disclosure may have, in some implementations, e.g., up to 600 nucleotides, up to 800 nucleotides, up to 1,000 nucleotides, or more, and each read of the fragment

may have, e.g., 50 nucleotides, 75 nucleotides, 150 nucleotides, 200 nucleotides, 300 nucleotides, 500 nucleotides, or more, from each end of the nucleotide DNA fragment. Likewise, nothing in FIG. 3 or any other figure should be interpreted as limiting a number of clusters of fragments. For example, a nucleic acid sequencer **310** may perform massively parallel sequencing, with millions of clusters of multiple fragments being sequenced simultaneously.

(76) Though the example of FIG. 3 relates to multiple samples that are used to generate reads having an index or sample identifier, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, the system **300** can also be used to process a single sample that generates reads that are not indexed—because all the reads belong to the same sample. In such implementations, the same processes could be performed with the second read interval, “Read 2”, being initiated immediately after the first read interval “Read 1,” without the generation of any indexes. Then, once the first read interval “Read 1” is completed, the second read interval “Read 2” can be initiated while the secondary analysis of the first reads are parallelized with the second read interval. The only substantial difference between the single sample implementation and the multiple sample implementation is that the index generation and demultiplexing stages do not need to be performed in the single sample—as all reads are associated with the same sample.

(77) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of an example of a process **400** for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 3. In general, the process **400** includes obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during a first read interval (**410**), obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during a second read interval (**420**) that is performed after the first read interval (**410**), while the second data is being obtained in stage **420** (I) organizing the plurality of first reads into organized groups based on a at least a first or second sample identifier associated with each of the first reads, (II) performing, for each organized group of first reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads and (III) storing the results of the secondary analysis of each group of first reads (**430**), and, thereafter, instructing the secondary analysis unit to begin (A) organizing the plurality of second reads into a plurality of organized groups based on at least a first or second sample identifier (**440**), and (B) performing, for each organized group of second reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of second reads, or on the organized group of first and second reads (**450**). For convenience, and not as a limitation, these stages will be described in more detail below as being performed by a sequencing system such as system **300** of FIG. 3.

(78) A sequencing system can begin execution of the process **400** by obtaining **410** first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during a first read interval. Obtaining the first data can include storing the first data representing the plurality of first reads in a memory device such as a memory device of a secondary analysis unit after the first data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof.

(79) Each read of the plurality of first reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a first end of a nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may have been clonally amplified to facilitate sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generate the nucleotides of the read. Each first read can include data identifying the sample used to generate the first read. In some implementations, the data identifying the sample can include a barcode. The nucleic acid sequencing device can include any nucleic acid sequencing device

including a DNA sequencer or an RNA sequencer.

(80) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **400** by obtaining **420** second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval. Obtaining the second data can include storing the second data representing the plurality of first reads in a memory of the secondary analysis unit after the second data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof.

(81) In some implementations, at least a portion of the second data is obtained while another portion of the second data is being generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. Each read of the plurality of second reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a second end of the nucleic acid fragment that is opposite of the first end of the nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may have been clonally amplified to facilitate sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generate the nucleotides of the read. Each second read can include data identifying a sample from which second read originated. In some implementations, the data identifying the sample can include a barcode.

(82) While the second data is being obtained in stage **420** the sequencing system can use a secondary analysis unit to parallelize additional processing of the plurality of first reads. In some implementations, the additional parallelized processing can include (I) organizing the data representing the plurality of first reads into organized groups based on at least a first or second sample identifier associated with each of the first reads, (II) performing, for each organized group of first reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads and (III) storing the results of the secondary analysis of each group of first reads (**430**).

(83) Organizing the plurality of first reads into the organized groups based on the sample identifier is necessary to obtain relevant secondary analysis processing when there are multiple samples being sequenced. This can include performing one or more demultiplexing operations to map the set of first reads having different first sample identifiers to respective organized groups, with each organized group of first reads having the same sample identifier. Demultiplexing statistics can be generated that describe a quality of the demultiplexing operations. For example, the demultiplexing statistics can indicate a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier. In some implementations, the secondary analysis unit can return results data to the nucleic acid sequencer, provide the results data to one or more artificially intelligent agents or models, or output the results data to one or more human users that describes the demultiplexing statistics. In such instances, the sequencing system can determine whether to continue with the process **400** or terminate the process **400** at this time, based on the quality of the demultiplex operation described by the demultiplexing statistics. Alternatively, such demultiplexing statistics can be returned as results data after mapping and aligning operations are performed, as described below.

(84) Once the plurality of first reads have been organized, the sequencing system can perform, for each organized group of first reads, one or more secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads. Performing secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads can include, for each organized group of first reads, (I) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the organized group of first reads to a mapping and aligning unit to align the organized group of first reads to a reference sequence, (II) aligning, using the mapping and aligning unit, the organized group of first reads to a reference sequence, (iii) receiving, from the mapping and aligning unit, a result, and (iv) storing the received result data before completion of the obtaining of the second data at stage **420**.

(85) The results data can include demultiplexing statistics or mapping and aligning statistics. The demultiplexing statistics can include data describing the quality of the demultiplexing operation such as a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier. The mapping and aligning statistics can include data describing a quality of the alignment of each organized group of first reads to a respective reference sequence. The mapping and alignment statistics can include, for example, one or more of a MAPQ score, an alignment score, or the like. In other implementations, the mapping and alignment results can include mapped and aligned reads for each organized group of first reads that can be provided as an input to a variant caller for a determination of potential variants between the mapped and aligned reads for each organized group of first reads and a respective reference sequence.

(86) In some implementations, output data describing the results data for each organized group of first reads can be provided for review by one or more human users. For example, output data describing the results data for each organized group of first reads can be output on a display coupled, e.g., to the nucleic acid sequencing device or provided in another room or building. Alternatively, or in addition, output data describing the results data for each organized group of first reads can be output using a printer communicatively coupled, e.g., directly or indirectly, to the nucleic acid sequencing device to print a report describing the alignment results for each organized group of first reads.

(87) In some implementations, the sequencing system, a remote computer, one or more human users, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, can evaluate the results data while the second data is being obtained in stage **420**. For example, the results data can be evaluated to determine whether the demultiplexed first reads, mapping and alignment of the first reads, or both, is of sufficient quality to continue obtaining second data in stage **420**. In some implementations, if the results data for the organized groups of first reads does not satisfy one or more predetermined rules or thresholds, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be instructed to stop obtaining the second data in stage **420**. Alternatively, if it is determined that the results data for the organized groups of first reads satisfies the one or more predetermined rules or thresholds, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be permitted to continue obtaining the second data in stage **420**.

(88) In some implementations, each organized group of mapped and aligned first reads can be evaluated for the detection of potential variants while the second data is being obtained at stage **420**. Such implementations can enable tertiary analysis of the variants identified for each group to be achieved quicker than conventional methods, which would prohibit the beginning of tertiary analysis until after completion of both the first read interval and the second read interval. Thus, initial diagnosis can be obtained to start treatment as much as 12-24 hours earlier than conventional methods by not having to wait for the second read interval to complete before proceeding to tertiary analysis.

(89) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **400** by instructing, at stage **430**, the mapping and aligning unit to begin organizing the plurality of second reads into a plurality of organized groups of second reads based on at least a first or a second sample identifier. Organizing the plurality of second reads into the organized groups based on the second sample identifiers is necessary to obtain relevant secondary analysis processing of the second reads. This can include performing one or more demultiplexing operations to map the set of second reads having different sample identifiers to different organized groups, with each organized group of second reads having the same second sample identifier. The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **400** performing, for each organized group of second reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of second reads (stage **440**). In some implementations the secondary analysis operations can be performed on a combination of the first and the second reads.

(90) In some implementations, the sequencing system may proceed to stages **430** and **440**. Such implementations still provide technical advantages of expediting tertiary analysis and reduction in downtime for the nucleic acid sequencer. However, in other implementations, execution of the

process **400** by the sequencing system may only continue with organizing the plurality of second reads into a plurality of organized groups (**430**) and perform secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning, variant calling, or both, if the received results data for each of the organized groups of first reads describing the demultiplex quality of the first reads, the mapping and alignment quality of the first reads, or both, is determined to satisfy one or more predetermined quality rules or thresholds.

(91) In some implementations, the sequencing system can rely on the secondary analysis results of mapping and aligning, variant calling, or both, of the organized groups of first reads performed at stage **420** while the second data was being obtained. In other implementations, these initial secondary analysis results related to the organized groups of first reads performed at stage **420** can be discarded after they are evaluated to determine quality of the first read interval. In such instances, the sequencing system can initiate second iteration of the secondary analysis of the organized groups of first reads either before or after secondary analysis of the organized groups of second reads at stages **430** and **440** is completed.

(92) FIG. 5 is a contextual diagram of an example of a system **500** for performing incremental secondary analysis of one or more samples using a secondary analysis unit within a nucleic acid sequencer. The system **500** is generally the same as system **300** described with reference to FIG. 3 with a few differences. One difference is that the secondary analysis unit **540** is located within the nucleic acid sequencer **510**. For any reference numeral of FIG. 5 not explicitly mentioned, the component identified by the reference numeral has the same features as its corresponding feature in FIG. 1 or 3. By way of example, respective clusters **522-1**, **522-2**, **522-3**, **522-4**, **522-5**, **522-N** have the same meaning as clusters **122-1**, **122-2**, **122-3**, **122-4**, **122-5**, **122-N**, respectively, of FIG. 1, unless additional or different features are described with reference to FIG. 5.

(93) Another difference between the example of FIG. 5 and the example of FIG. 3 is that the nucleic acid sequencer has been configured to generate sample identifiers or indexes for each read prior to the first read interval. This is illustrated in the workflow **570**, which shows that IND1 and IND2 are generated following the clustering stage and prior to the first read the first read interval “READ 1” of workflow **570**. This is different than the generation of the sample identifiers or indexes in the example of FIG. 3, as the indexes of FIG. 3 are generated after the first read interval. Though the implementation of FIGS. 5 and 6 are described as generated separate sample identifiers or indexes for “READ 1” and “READ 2,” the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, implementations of the present disclosure may only generate a single sample identifier or index identifier that refers to both “READ 1” and “READ 2” of a particular fragment.

(94) The benefit of generating the sample identifier prior to the first read intervals that organizing reads into demultiplexed groups having the same sample identifier can be performed at runtime, as reads are generated. Given the generation of all sample identifiers and the ability to organize reads based on sample identifiers at runtime, the system **500** is able to begin secondary analysis of organized groups of first reads during the first read interval. In such a scenario, secondary analysis results data including demultiplexing statistics, mapping and aligning statistics, or both, for each organized group of first reads, can be obtained and evaluated during a first read interval-thus enabling the option to terminate the first read interval if the results data is indicating less than satisfactory results, thereby conserving reagent.

(95) Moreover, the ability to begin performing secondary analysis of organized groups of first reads during a first read interval enables an even faster transition to tertiary analysis operations than the examples of systems described with reference to FIG. 1B and FIG. 3. The system of FIG. 5 can transition to tertiary analysis faster than the systems of FIG. 1B and FIG. 3 because an initial set of variants, based on mapped and aligned first reads and used as inputs for tertiary analysis, can be identified during the first read interval. This enables the start of tertiary analysis within less than in about hours from beginning of the first read interval. That is in contrast to the examples of FIG. 1B and FIG. 3, which could not start tertiary analysis using identified variants of mapped and aligned

reads as inputs until after the sequencing is complete, respectively.

(96) With reference to the example of FIG. 5, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** can configure the programmable circuit **542** of the secondary analysis unit **540** to include a mapping and alignment unit **542a**. The nucleic acid sequencer **510** can receive multiple samples **105**, **106**, **107**. The samples **105**, **106**, **107** can include, for example, nucleic acid samples from different species. The different species can be different persons, different animals, different plants, or the like. The nucleic acid sequencer **510** can prepare the samples **105**, **106**, **107** and perform cluster generation during time **T1** of the workflow **570**.

(97) At the conclusion of the cluster stage, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** begins generating indexes, or sample identifiers, for each first read that will be produced by the nucleic acid sequencer **510** during time **T2A**. At the end of time **T2A**, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** begins generated indexes or sample identifiers for each second read that will be produced by the nucleic acid sequencer **510** during time **T2B**. The index, or sample identifier for each read can include any data that can be used to create a logical relationship between a read and a sample. Thus, at the end of Time **T1+T2A+T2B** in the example of FIG. 5, indexes, or sample identifiers, index have been created for each first read that will be generated by the nucleic acid sequencer **510** during the first read interval, and indexes, or sample identifiers have also been created for each second read that will be generated by the nucleic acid sequencer **510** during the second read interval.

(98) The nucleic acid sequencer **510** is configured to parallelize secondary analysis operations such as mapping and aligning of at least a portion of the first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1**, **532-3**, **534-1**, **534-3** while the nucleic acid sequencer **510** continues to perform sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis of a first read interval during time **T3**. Beginning secondary analysis of at least a portion of the first reads during the first read interval could not be achieved in the example of FIG. 3 because the indexes, or sample identifiers for each read were not generated until after the first read interval was complete. In contrast, in the example of FIG. 5, the indexes, or sample identifiers index for each read that is to be generated by the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, are created in advance.

(99) In the example of FIG. 5, the first read interval does not begin until after the time **T1+T2A+T2B** of workflow **570** is complete. After the expiration of **T1+T2A+T2B**, the nucleic acid sequencer **570** can begin the first read interval. Beginning the first read interval can include initiating primary analysis sequencing operations such as sequencing-by-synthesis to generate one or more first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1**, **532-3**, **534-1**, **534-3**. After time **TX** from the beginning of the first read interval “Read 1,” one or more first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1** that have been generated during time **TX** can then be stored in the memory **544** of the secondary analysis unit **540** or other memory that is accessible by the secondary analysis unit **540**, the processing unit **150**, or both.

(100) Because the nucleic acid sequencer **510** is sequencing multiple samples, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** needs to perform an organization operation to organize the one or more first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1** into one or more organized groups of first reads. Organizing the first reads can be achieved using the demultiplexing unit **562**. For example, the processing unit **550** can access the one or more reads stored in the memory **544**, memory **560**, or other memory, and execute the programmed functionality of the demultiplexing unit **562** to demultiplex the one or more first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1** into one or more organized groups of first reads. Demultiplexing can be achieved using one or more demultiplexing operations to organize the one or more first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1** based on the index or sample identifier for the respective first reads. The demultiplexed first reads can be stored in the memory **544** or other memory accessible to the mapping and aligning unit **542a**.

(101) The mapping and aligning unit **542a** can access the organized first reads stored in the memory **544** and perform real-time mapping and aligning operations on the demultiplexed first reads during the first read interval. The secondary analysis unit **540** can generate results **549** for

each group of first reads stored in the memory **544**. The results **549** can include demultiplexing statistics, mapping and aligning statistics, mapping and aligning results, or a combination thereof. The secondary analysis unit **540** can store the received results in the memory **560**. The demultiplexing statistics can include data describing a demultiplex quality such as a number of records corresponding to each sample identifier. The mapping and aligning statistics such as, for example, a MAPQ score that provides an indication of mapping quality of each group of first reads, an alignment score that provides an indication of alignment quality of each group of first reads, or the like. The mapping and aligning results **549** can include data describing the mapped and aligned reads. In some implementations, these mapping and aligning results can be dynamically updated as more first reads are generated and mapped and aligned to respective reference sequences.

(102) In the example of FIG. 5, the ultrafast execution times of the mapping and aligning unit **542a** implemented using hardwired logic of the programmable circuit **542** enables the mapping and aligning unit **542a** to perform mapping and aligning of the respective demultiplexed groups of first reads **530-1**, **530-3**, **532-1**, **532-3**, **534-1**, **534-3** in a fraction of the time that is required, by the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, to perform the first read interval. For example, in some implementations, the programmable circuit **542a** can perform mapping and aligning of the demultiplexed groups of first reads generated during time TX in hardwired logic during the first read interval “Read 1” in minutes, or less, while execution of the entire first read interval using software executed by the processing unit **150** can take 12 to 24 hours. Thus, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** or one or more human users can evaluate the results **549** of secondary analysis of the first reads such as those first reads generated during time TX while the remainder of the first reads are generated by the nucleic acid sequencer **510** during time T3. Then, the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, a user of the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, an artificially intelligent agent or model, or a combination thereof, can make a determination, based on the quality of the demultiplexing operation, the mapping and aligning operation, or both, by the results **549** whether the nucleic acid sequencer **510** should continue performance of sequencing operations during the first read interval. This determination as to whether sequencing operations during the first read interval should be continued can be made automatically by the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, automatically by an artificially intelligent agent or model, a user of the nucleic acid sequencer, or based on data describing a determination from each of these entities as described with reference to the example of FIG. 1B.

(103) Using these techniques, the system **500** of FIG. 5 provides even better technological advantages described with reference to FIG. 1B. That is, the system **500** can conserve reagents that would be used to continue generating additional reads during the first read interval if the results **549** indicates that the demultiplexing of at least a portion of the first reads already generated during the first read interval, alignment of a portion of the first reads already generated during the first read interval, or both, is of low quality. Once a determination has been made that the demultiplex quality of the already generated first reads, mapping and alignment quality of the already generated first reads, or both, is satisfactory, the nucleic acid sequencer **510** can discard the mapping and aligning results **549**. In other implementations, the mapping and alignment of the already generated first reads performed in parallel with the first read interval can be used as the mapping and alignment of the final data run of the first reads.

(104) In addition to demultiplexing and mapping and aligning, the secondary analysis unit **540** can also perform variant calling operations of the one or more groups of mapped and aligned first reads during the first read interval “Read 1.” By way of example, the processing unit **550** can be used to execute the variant calling unit **564** which can analyze mapped and aligned reads to identify the occurrence of any variants such as single nucleotide polymorphisms (SNPs), insertions/deletions (indels), structural variations, or the like. In some implementations, the programmable circuit **542** can be dynamically reconfigured, for example by the nucleic acid sequencer **510**, to aid variant calling processing. For example the programmable circuit **542** can be dynamically reconfigured to

include an HMM unit that can be used to perform probability calculations as to the likely occurrence of a variant at one or more reference locations of mapped and aligned reads. The nucleic acid sequencer **510**, or other computer device, can then perform one or more tertiary analysis operations, during the first read interval “Read 1,” using any identified variants. This can help expedite treatment to an entity based on the tertiary analysis. An entity can include a patient, person, subject, plant, animal, or the like.

(105) In the example of system **500**, if a determination is made to terminate the first read interval based on a determination that the demultiplexing statistics, mapping and aligning statistics, or both, are of low quality, the system **500** may also terminate the second read interval “Read 2.” Thus, the system **500** provides additional advantages over the examples of the system of FIG. 1B or FIG. 3 in that even more reagent can be conserved in the event low quality demultiplexing results, mapping and aligning results, or both, are detected.

(106) However, with reference to the example of system **500**, if a determination is made that the demultiplexing results, mapping and aligning results, or both, satisfy a threshold level of quality, then the system **500** can begin execution of the second read interval “Read 2,” as shown in workflow **570**. In some implementations, the system **500** can generate the second read interval “Read 2” without parallelizing the secondary analysis of the second reads. Such execution may be preferable because, for example, the system **500** would already have evaluated the sequencing quality during the first read interval “Read 1.” However, in other implementations, the system **500** can parallelize the secondary analysis of the second reads in the same manner as secondary analysis of the first reads was parallelized with the first read interval.

(107) The example of FIG. 5 describes an example having reads with 8 nucleotides and 3 samples. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, this simple example is being presented to explain features of the present disclosure in a manner that is easy to understand. In practice, a DNA fragments of the present disclosure may have, in some implementations, e.g., up to 600 nucleotides, up to 800 nucleotides, up to 1,000 nucleotides, or more, and each read of the fragment may have, e.g., 50 nucleotides, 75 nucleotides, 150 nucleotides, 200 nucleotides, 300 nucleotides, 500 nucleotides, or more, from each end of the DNA fragment. Likewise, nothing in FIG. 5 or any other figure should be interpreted as limiting a number of clusters of fragments. For example, a nucleic acid sequencer **510** may perform massively parallel sequencing, with millions of clusters of multiple fragments being sequenced simultaneously.

(108) Though the example of FIG. 5 relates to multiple samples that are used to generate reads having an index or sample identifier, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, the system **500** can also be used to process a single sample that generates reads that are not indexed—because all the reads belong to the same sample. In such implementations, the same processes could be performed with the first read interval being initiated immediately after the clustering stage. Then, once a portion of the first reads are generated during the first read interval “Read 1,” the system **500** can provide the generated portion of the first reads to the mapping and aligning unit **542a** for mapping and aligning while the remaining portion of the first reads are generated during the first read interval without the need to perform the demultiplexing stage. In this implementation, the first reads do not need to be demultiplexed because they are all associated with the same sample. Similarity, the portion of the mapped and aligned first reads can then be analyzed for variants using the first read interval “Read 1,” as described above. Similar determinations can be made as to whether to continue with the first read interval and second read interval as explained with respect to the example FIG. 5. In sum, the substantive difference between a single sample implementation of system **500** of FIG. 5 and the multiple sample implementations of FIG. 5 is that with the single sample implementation, the demultiplexing stages do not need to be performed.

(109) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of an example of a process **600** for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 5. In general, the process **600** includes generating a plurality of first sample identifiers, where each first sample identifier corresponds to a

particular read that will be generated during a first read interval (**610**), generating a plurality of second sample identifiers, where each second sample identifier corresponds to a particular read that will be generated during a second read interval (**620**), obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during the first read interval, where each of the plurality of first reads corresponds to at least one of the first or second sample identifiers (**630**), while obtaining the first data at stage **630** (I) organizing the plurality of first reads into organized groups based on at least a first or second sample identifier associated with each of the first reads, (II) performing, for each organized group of first reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads and (III) storing the results of the secondary analysis of each group of first reads (**640**), obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during the second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, where each of the plurality of second reads corresponds to at least one of the first or second sample identifiers (**650**), and performing secondary analysis on the obtained second data (**660**). For convenience, and without limitation, these stages will be described in more detail below as being performed by a sequencing system such as system **500** of FIG. 5.

(110) A sequencing system can begin execution of the process **600** by generating **610** a plurality of first sample identifiers, where each first sample identifier corresponds to a particular read that will be generated during a first read interval. In some implementations, each first sample identifier can include an index tag sequence. The index tag sequence may be attached to a target polynucleotides of each sample before the respective samples are immobilized for sequencing. The index tag may be a synthetic sequence of nucleotides which is added to the target as part of the template preparation step. Accordingly, a library-specific index tag is a nucleic acid sequence tag which is attached to each of the target molecules of a sample, the presence of which is indicative of or is used to identify the entity from which the target molecules were isolated. In some implementations, the index tag sequence can include a barcode embedded into the synthetic sequence.

(111) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **600**, at stage **620**, by generating a plurality of second sample identifiers, where each second sample identifier corresponds to a particular read that will be generated during a second read interval that occurs after the first read interval. In some implementations, each second sample identifier can include an index tag sequence. The index tag sequence may be attached to a target polynucleotides of each sample before the respective samples are immobilized for sequencing. The index tag may be a synthetic sequence of nucleotides which is added to the target as part of the template preparation step. Accordingly, a library-specific index tag is a nucleic acid sequence tag which is attached to each of the target molecules of a sample, the presence of which is indicative of or is used to identify the entity from which the target molecules were isolated. In some implementations, the index tag sequence can include a barcode embedded into the synthetic sequence.

(112) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **600**, at stage **630**, by obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during the first read interval, where each of the plurality of first reads corresponds to one of the first sample identifiers. Obtaining the first data can include storing the first data representing one or more first reads in a memory of a secondary analysis unit after the first data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof. In some implementation, at least a portion of the first data is obtained while another portion of the first data is being generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. That is, data representing a first set of one or more reads can be obtained and stored in a memory of the secondary analysis unit while one or more other first reads are generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during the first read

interval.

(113) Each read of the plurality of first reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a first end of the nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may have been clonally amplified to facilitate sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generate the nucleotides of the read. Each first sample identifier of each first read, generated in advance of the first read interval, corresponds respectively to a particular sample from which the first read originated. The first sample identifier can be used by the sequencing system to determine a sample associated with any particular first read. In some implementations, the data identifying the sample can include a barcode.

(114) While obtaining the first data at stage **630** during the first read interval, the sequencing system can use a secondary analysis unit to parallelize additional processing of one or more of the first reads, in real time, that have already been generated by the nucleic acid sequencer. In some implementations, the additional processing can include (I) organizing the plurality of first reads into organized groups based on at least a first or a second sample identifier associated with each of the first reads, (II) performing, for each organized group of first reads, secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads and (III) storing the results of the secondary analysis of each group of first reads (stage **640**).

(115) Organizing the one or more first reads into the organized groups based on the sample identifier is necessary to obtain relevant secondary analysis processing when multiple samples are sequenced. This can include performing one or more demultiplexing operations to map the one or more first reads having different first sample identifiers to respective organized groups, with each organized group of first reads having the same sample identifier. Demultiplexing statistics can be generated that describe the quality of the demultiplex operations. For example, the demultiplexing statistics can indicate a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier. In some implementations, the secondary analysis unit can return results data to the nucleic acid sequencer, provide the results data to one or more artificially intelligent agents or models, or output the results data to one or more human users that describes the demultiplexing statistics. In such instances, the sequencing system can determine whether to continue with the process **600** or terminate the process **600** at this time, based on the quality of the demultiplex operation described by the demultiplexing statistics. Alternatively, such demultiplexing statistics can be returned as results data after mapping and aligning operations are performed, as described below.

(116) Once the one or more first reads have been organized, the sequencing system can perform, for each organized group of first reads, one or more secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads in parallel with the remainder of first read interval using a secondary analysis unit. Performing secondary analysis operations on the organized group of first reads can include, for each organized group of first reads, (I) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the organized group of first reads to a mapping and aligning unit to align the organized group of first reads to a reference sequence, (II) aligning, using the mapping and aligning unit, the organized group of first reads to a reference sequence, (III) receiving, from the mapping and aligning unit, results data, and (IV) storing the received alignment results data before completion of the obtaining of the first data at stage **630**.

(117) The results data can include demultiplexing statistics or mapping and aligning statistics. The demultiplexing statistics can include data describing the quality of the demultiplexing operation such as a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier. The mapping and aligning statistics can include data describing a quality of the alignment of each organized group of first reads to a respective reference sequence. The mapping and aligning statistics can include, for example, one or more of a MAPQ score, an alignment score, or the like. In other implementations, the mapping and aligning results can include mapped and aligned reads for each organized group of

first reads that can be provided as an input to a variant caller for a determination of potential variants between the mapped and aligned reads for each organized group of first reads and a respective reference sequence.

(118) In some implementations, output data describing the results data for each organized group of first reads can be provided for review by one or more human users. For example, output data describing the results data for each organized group of first reads can be output on a display, e.g., coupled to the nucleic acid sequencing device or provided in another room or building.

Alternatively, or in addition, output data describing the alignment results for each organized group of first reads can be output using a printer communicatively coupled, e.g., directly or indirectly, to the nucleic acid sequencing device to print a report describing the alignment results for each organized group of first reads.

(119) In some implementations, the sequencing system, one or more human users, one or more artificially intelligent agents or models, or a combination thereof, can evaluate the alignments results while the first data is being obtained in stage **630**. For example, the results data can be evaluated to determine whether the demultiplexing of the obtained first reads, the mapping and alignment of the obtained first reads, or a combination of both, is of sufficient quality to continue obtaining first data in stage **630**. In some implementations, if the results data for the organized groups of first reads does not satisfy one or more predetermined rules or thresholds, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be instructed to stop obtaining the first data during the first read interval in stage **630**. Alternatively, if it is determined that the results data for the organized groups of first reads satisfies the one or more predetermined rules or thresholds, then the nucleic acid sequencer can be permitted to continue obtaining the first data during the first read interval in stage **630**.

(120) In some implementations, each organized group of mapped and aligned first reads can be evaluated for the detection of potential variants while the first data is being obtained at stage **630**. Such implementations can enable tertiary analysis of the variants identified for each group to be achieved quicker than conventional methods, which would prohibit the beginning of tertiary analysis until after completion of both the first read interval in stage **630** and the second read interval in stage **650**. Thus, initial diagnosis can be obtained in order to start treatment days earlier than conventional methods, shown in FIG. **1A**, by not having to wait for completion of the first read interval, second read interval, and mapping and aligning of the first and second reads before proceeding to tertiary analysis.

(121) At the conclusion of stage **630**, the sequencing system can continue execution of the process **600** by obtaining **650** second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device, from multiple different samples, during the second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, where each of the plurality of second reads corresponds to one of at least the first or the second sample identifier. Obtaining the second data can include storing the second data representing one or more second reads generated during a second read interval in a memory of device of the secondary analysis unit after the second data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof. In some implementation, at least a portion of the second data is obtained while another portion of the second data is being generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. That is, data representing a second set of one or more reads can be obtained and stored in a memory of the sequencing device while one or more other second reads are generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during the second read interval.

(122) Each read of the plurality of second reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a second end of the nucleic acid fragment that is opposite the first end of the nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may have been clonally amplified to facilitate

sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generate the nucleotides of the read. Each second sample identifier of each second read, generated in advance of the second read interval, corresponds respectively to a particular identifier of the second read. The second sample identifier can be used by the sequencing system to determine a sample associated with any particular second read. In some implementations, the data identifying the sample can include a barcode.

(123) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **600** by performing **660** secondary analysis on the obtained second data. In some implementations, the sequencing system can proceed to stage **660** after completion of stage **650**. In the context of process **600**, this may occur while still achieving at least some of benefits of the present disclosure such as expedited tertiary analysis because sequencing quality could be evaluated during the first read interval in stage **640** and reduction of downtime for the nucleic acid sequencer. However, the present disclosure is not so limited. Instead, in some implementations, the sequencing system can parallelize the secondary analysis of the second reads in the same manner as secondary analysis of the first reads was parallelized with the first read interval.

(124) In some implementations, the sequencing system can rely on the secondary analysis results of mapping and aligning, variant calling, or both, of the organized groups of first reads performed at stage **640** while the first data was being obtained during the first read interval. In other implementations, these initial secondary analysis results related to the organized groups of first reads performed at stage **640** can be discarded after they are evaluated to determine quality of the first read interval. In such instances, the sequencing system can initiate a second iteration of the secondary analysis of the organized groups of first reads either before or after secondary analysis of the organized groups of second reads at stage **660** is completed.

(125) FIG. 7 is an example of a workflow diagram **770** describing a workflow of operations executed during a process for performing incremental secondary analysis using a secondary analysis unit. The workflow diagram **770** is the same as the workflow diagram **370** shown in FIG. 3. However, in FIG. 7, a sequence **710** of additional operations that are to be performed during a final data run have been overlayed on top of the workflow diagram **770**.

(126) In some implementations, a final data run can include secondary analysis, or other additional processing, that will yield secondary analysis results having a threshold level of confidence. In conventional sequencing systems, a final data run cannot be achieved by conventional sequencing systems until both the first read interval and second read interval have been completed. Moreover, such conventional systems also have sequencer downtime between end of a first sequencing run and a start of a second sequencing run, as shown in FIG. 1A. Though example implementations that use a threshold level of confidence is described, other implementations can be employed that do not utilize such thresholds.

(127) In the example of FIG. 7, a sequencing system such as the sequencing system of FIG. 3 or 5 can be configured to begin a final data run at time TY before the conclusion of the second read interval. The time TY can be, for example, a predetermined number of one or more sequencing cycles from the end of the second read interval, where a cycle refers to the time required to generate a single nucleic acid from a read. In some implementations, the nucleic acid sequencer can be configured to detect when it is a predetermined number of sequencing cycles from the end of the second read interval "Read 2," and initiate performance of the secondary analysis on one or more first reads generated during the first read interval "Read 1." The first reads can include one or more organized sets of reads that have been previously demultiplexed at the conclusion of time T3B in workflow of FIG. 7. Initiating performance of secondary analysis can include, for example, instructing a secondary analysis unit to perform mapping and aligning, variant calling of mapped and aligned reads, or both.

(128) Once initiated, the secondary analysis unit can continue to perform secondary analysis

operations of reads generating during the first and second read intervals of the first sequencing run until the triggered secondary analysis operations are completed. As shown in FIG. 7, execution of the secondary analysis operations using the secondary analysis unit can begin during a first sequencing run and continue executing during a second sequencing run that begins after completion of the first sequencing run. The secondary analysis operations on the reads generated during the first sequencing run will complete during the second sequencing run. This parallelization of secondary analysis corresponding to the first sequencing run with the operations of the second sequencing run thus enables a nucleic acid sequencer to continue sequencing runs, with little to no sequencer downtime, thus increasing reagent consumption and revenue derived therefrom. The operations of the second sequencing run that overlap with the secondary analysis of the first sequencing run can include, but are not limited to, the setup, clustering, or primary analysis of the second sequencing run.

(129) In the example of FIG. 7, the parallelization of secondary analysis of the first sequencing run and operations of the second sequencing run is not being performed to evaluate the quality of the reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencer in an effort to determine whether the second read interval should continue. Instead, the parallelization of secondary analysis and operations of the second sequencing run is being performed as part of the final data run, making the final result data suitable for use in subsequent operations such as during tertiary analysis.

(130) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of an example of a process **800** for performing incremental secondary analysis in accordance with the workflow diagram of FIG. 7. In general, the obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval of a first sequencing run (**810**), obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval of a first sequencing run that is performed after the first read interval (**820**), while obtaining at least a portion of the second data at stage **820**, initiating performance of one or more secondary analysis operations on at least the first data or second data (**830**), using the nucleic acid sequencing device to perform a second sequencing run (**840**), and while using the nucleic acid sequencing device to perform a second sequencing run at stage **840**, (I) continuing performance of the one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data or the second data, and (II) storing results data representing the results of the secondary analysis operations (**850**). For convenience, and without limitation, these stages will be described in more detail below as being performed by a sequencing system such as system **100**, **300**, or **500** of FIGS. 1A, 3, or 5, respectively.

(131) A sequencing system can begin performance of the process **800**, at stage **810**, by obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval of a first sequencing run. Obtaining the first data can include storing the first data describing the plurality of first reads in a memory device such as a memory device of a secondary analysis unit after the first data is generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof.

(132) Each read of the plurality of first reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a first end of a nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may be have been clonally amplified to facilitate sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generated the nucleotides of the read. The nucleic acid sequencing device can include any nucleic acid sequencing device including a DNA sequencer or an RNA sequencer. The first sequencing run can include a complete performance of primary analysis of one or more biological samples by the nucleic acid sequencing device. An example of the stages of a complete first sequencing run is

shown in FIG. 7 and includes a clustering stage, first read interval, and a second read interval. In some implementations, such as the one shown in FIG. 7, primary analysis can also include one or more indexing stages.

(133) The sequencing system can continue performance of the process **800**, at stage **820**, by obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval of a first sequencing run that is performed after the first read interval. Obtaining the second data can include storing the second data representing the plurality of second reads in a memory of a secondary analysis unit after the second data is generated by the sequencing device. The memory device of the secondary analysis unit may be a memory unit that is accessible by an integrated circuit of the secondary analysis unit configured to perform secondary analysis operations. The integrated circuit can include one or more programmable circuits, one or more ASICs, or a combination thereof. In some implementation, at least a portion of the second data is obtained while another portion of the second data is being generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device. Each read of the plurality of second reads may be comprised of an ordered sequence of nucleotides. In some implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides can correspond to nucleotides of a second end of the nucleic acid fragment that is opposite of the first end of the nucleic acid fragment. The nucleic acid fragment may be have been clonally amplified to facilitate sequencing and, in such implementations, the ordered sequence of nucleotides may be determined by analyzing plurality of clones of the nucleic acid fragment to generated the nucleotides of the read.

(134) While obtaining at least a portion of the second data at stage **820**, the sequencing system can continue performance of the process **800**, at stage **830**, by initiating performance of one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data or second data. Initiating performance of one or more secondary analysis operations can include dynamically configuring a programmable circuit to include hardwired logic to perform a secondary analysis operation, and then performing at least one secondary analysis operation for one or more reads generated during the first sequencing run. For example, the sequencing system can dynamically configure a programmable circuit as a mapping and aligning unit, and then use the hardwired logic of mapping and aligning unit to perform mapping and aligning of at least one read generated during the first sequencing run. In other implementations, initiating performance of one or more secondary analysis operations can include instructing an ASIC to execute hardwired digital logic to perform the secondary analysis operation on one or more reads generated during the first sequencing run.

(135) In some implementations, such as when multiple samples were sequenced during the first sequencing run, the first reads or the second reads may need to be organized into demultiplexed groups prior to mapping and aligning. In such implementations, at least a portion of the organization of the first read, the second reads, or both, can also be performed during stage **820**.

(136) The sequencing system can continue performance of the process **800**, at stage **840**, by using the nucleic acid sequencing device to perform a second sequencing run. The second sequencing run can includes a complete performance of primary analysis of one or more biological samples by the nucleic acid sequencing device. In some implementations, the second sequencing run can sequence one or more different biological samples than those biological samples sequenced during the first sequencing run. The second sequencing run can include a clustering stage, first read interval, and a second read interval. In some implementations, primary analysis can also include one or more indexing stages.

(137) While using the nucleic acid sequencing device to perform a second sequencing run at stage **840**, (I) continuing **850** performance of the one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data or the second data, and (II) storing results data representing the results of the secondary analysis operations. Continuing performance of the one or more secondary analysis operations on the first data or the second data generated during stages **810** or **820**, respectively, can include continuing performance of secondary analysis on the first and second data until secondary analysis

on the first and second data is complete. For example, the hardwired mapping and aligning unit that can be configured at stage **830** during the first sequencing run can continue performing mapping and aligning operations of first reads, second reads, or both, during the second sequencing run until mapping and aligning operations on the first reads, second reads, or both, are complete.

(138) FIG. **9** is flowchart of an example of a process **900** for performing dynamic programmable circuit context-switching. In general, the process **900** can include obtaining one or more genomic workflow attributes (**910**), determining, based on the one or more genomic workflow attributes, a workflow context-switching type for a programmable circuit, wherein the workflow context-switching type defines reconfiguration for the programmable circuit (**920**), and instructing the programmable circuit controller to perform secondary analysis using the determined context-switching type (**930**). For convenience, and without limitation, these stages will be described in more detail below as being performed by a sequencing system such as system **100**, **300**, or **500** of FIGS. **1A**, **3**, or **5**, respectively.

(139) A sequencing system can begin execution of the process **900**, at stage **910**, by obtaining one or more genomic workflow attributes. In some implementations, the one or more workflow attributes can include a workflow identifier that identifies a workflow selected by a user of a nucleic acid sequencer. Genomic workflows can include, for example, a whole genome sequencing workflow, an enrichment workflow, an RNA workflow, an Amplicon workflow, a Single Cell RNA workflow, or the like. Alternatively, or in addition, the one or more workflow attributes may include data describing a number of samples being sequenced by a nucleic acid sequencer. Alternatively, or in addition, the one or more workflow attributes can include a predetermined time threshold for execution of the workflow. Alternatively, or in addition, the one or more workflow attributes can include an amount of available computing resources available to the nucleic acid sequencer.

(140) The sequencing system can continue execution of the process **900**, at stage **920**, by determining, based on the one or more genomic workflow attributes, a workflow context-switching type for a programmable circuit, wherein the workflow context-switching type defines reconfiguration for the programmable circuit. Determining a workflow context-switching type can include selecting a particular workflow context-switching type from a plurality of context-switching types based on the one or more workflow attributes.

(141) A context-switching type defines how a programmable circuit will be dynamically reconfigured at runtime. By way of example, a first programmable circuit context can include the programmable circuit interlacing alignment and variant calling operations. In such implementations, the programmable circuit can be configured as a mapping and aligning unit to align reads corresponding to a first sample to a reference sequence, dynamically reconfigured as a variant calling unit to perform variant calling operations on the reads corresponding to the first aligned sample, dynamically reconfigured to map and align a reads corresponding to a second sample to the reference sequence, dynamically reconfigured as a variant calling unit to perform variant calling operations on the reads corresponding to a second aligned sample, and so on. In this context, the programmable circuit can dynamically switch back and forth between mapping and aligning and variant calling operations. This first programmable circuit context is preferred when there is only one sample or a small number of samples.

(142) By way of another example, a second programmable circuit context can include the programmable circuit performing all necessary alignments and then performing all necessary variant calling operations on the aligned reads. In such implementations, the programmable circuit can be configured as a mapping and aligning unit and align a first sample, align a second sample, align a third, etc., until all samples are aligned and then dynamically reconfigured as a variant calling unit to perform variant calling operations on the first aligned sample, perform variant calling operations on the second aligned sample, perform variant calling operations on the third aligned sample, etc. Because context-switching is an expensive computing function, this second

programmable circuit context can be selected when a workflow has a larger number of samples.

(143) In some implementations, the sequencing system can determine between the aforementioned context-switching types in a number of ways. For example, in some implementations, the sequencing system can obtain data such as a workflow identifier that is indicative of a workflow selection by a user of a nucleic acid sequencer. In some implementations, the sequencing system can be programmed to automatically select a particular context-switching type that is logically related to the obtained workflow identifier. A logical relationship can include, for example, a one-to-one mapping between the workflow identifier and context-switching type.

(144) Alternatively, or in addition, the sequencing system can determine between the aforementioned context-switching types based on a number of samples. For example, a predetermined threshold number of samples can be established. Then, if the nucleic acid sequencer determines that a particular workflow has more than a threshold number of samples, then the nucleic acid sequencer can select second programmable context. Alternatively, if the nucleic acid sequence determines that the number of samples does not exceed the threshold number of samples, then the nucleic acid sequencer can select the first programmable context.

(145) Alternatively, or in addition, the sequencing system can determine between the aforementioned context-switching types based on an estimated secondary analysis runtime. For example, a nucleic acid sequencer can be programmed to analyze data describing a received workflow, and estimate an estimated secondary analysis runtime using a default programmable circuit context, where the default programmable circuit context is the first programmable circuit context. In such implementations, if the estimated secondary analysis runtime is less than a predetermined threshold time, then the nucleic acid sequencer can select the first programmable circuit context. Alternatively, if the estimated secondary analysis runtime is more than a predetermined threshold time, then the nucleic acid sequencer can select the second programmable circuit context.

(146) These aforementioned implementations are mere examples of programmable circuit context types and context-switching that can be employed by the present disclosure. None of these examples should be viewed as limiting the scope of the present disclosure. Instead, other programmable circuit context types and context-switching types falls within the scope of the present disclosure.

(147) The sequencing system can continue performance of the process **900**, at stage **930**, by instructing the programmable circuit controller to perform secondary analysis using the determined context-switching type. The programmable circuit controller can include software, hardware, or combination of both, that configures the programmable logic of the programmable circuit. Based on the received instructions, the programmable circuit controller can dynamically configure the programmable circuit to include hardwired digital logic that is configured to perform the context-switching type identified by the instructions.

(148) FIG. **10** is a block diagram of an example of system components that can be used to implement a system for performing incremental secondary analysis.

(149) The computing device **1000** is intended to represent various forms of digital computers, such as laptops, desktops, workstations, personal digital assistants, servers, blade servers, mainframes, and other appropriate computers. In some implementations, the computing device **1000** can be a nucleic acid sequencer such as the nucleic acid sequencer of FIG. **1**, **3**, or **5**. The mobile computing device **1050** is intended to represent various forms of mobile devices, such as personal digital assistants, cellular telephones, smart-phones, mobile embedded radio systems, radio diagnostic computing devices, and other similar computing devices. The components shown here, their connections and relationships, and their functions, are meant to be examples only, and are not meant to be limiting.

(150) The computing device **1000** includes a processor **1002**, a memory **1004**, a storage device **1006**, a high-speed interface **1008** connecting to the memory **1004** and multiple high-speed

expansion ports **1010**, and a low-speed interface **1012** connecting to a low-speed expansion port **1014** and the storage device **1006**. Each of the processor **1002**, the memory **1004**, the storage device **1006**, the high-speed interface **1008**, the high-speed expansion ports **1010**, and the low-speed interface **1012**, are interconnected using various busses, and may be mounted on a common motherboard or in other manners as appropriate. The processor **1002** can process instructions for execution within the computing device **1000**, including instructions stored in the memory **1004** or on the storage device **1006** to display graphical information for a GUI on an external input/output device, such as a display **1016** coupled to the high-speed interface **1008**. In other implementations, multiple processors and/or multiple buses may be used, as appropriate, along with multiple memories and types of memory. In addition, multiple computing devices may be connected, with each device providing portions of the operations (e.g., as a server bank, a group of blade servers, or a multi-processor system). In some implementations, the processor **1002** is a single threaded processor. In some implementations, the processor **1002** is a multi-threaded processor. In some implementations, the processor **1002** is a quantum computer.

(151) The memory **1004** stores information within the computing device **1000**. In some implementations, the memory **1004** is a volatile memory unit or units. In some implementations, the memory **1004** is a non-volatile memory unit or units. The memory **1004** may also be another form of computer-readable medium, such as a magnetic or optical disk.

(152) The storage device **1006** is capable of providing mass storage for the computing device **1000**. In some implementations, the storage device **1006** may be or include a computer-readable medium, such as a floppy disk device, a hard disk device, an optical disk device, or a tape device, a flash memory or other similar solid-state memory device, or an array of devices, including devices in a storage area network or other configurations. Instructions can be stored in an information carrier. The instructions, when executed by one or more processing devices (for example, processor **1002**), perform one or more methods, such as those described above. The instructions can also be stored by one or more storage devices such as computer- or machine readable mediums (for example, the memory **1004**, the storage device **1006**, or memory on the processor **1002**). The high-speed interface **1008** manages bandwidth-intensive operations for the computing device **1000**, while the low-speed interface **1012** manages lower bandwidth-intensive operations. Such allocation of functions is an example only. In some implementations, the high speed interface **1008** is coupled to the memory **1004**, the display **1016** (e.g., through a graphics processor or accelerator), and to the high-speed expansion ports **1010**, which may accept various expansion cards (not shown). In the implementation, the low-speed interface **1012** is coupled to the storage device **1006** and the low-speed expansion port **1014**. The low-speed expansion port **1014**, which may include various communication ports (e.g., USB, Bluetooth, Ethernet, wireless Ethernet) may be coupled to one or more input/output devices, such as a keyboard, a pointing device, a scanner, or a networking device such as a switch or router, e.g., through a network adapter.

(153) The computing device **1000** may be implemented in a number of different forms, as shown in the figure. For example, it may be implemented as a standard server **1020**, or multiple times in a group of such servers. In addition, it may be implemented in a personal computer such as a laptop computer **1022**. It may also be implemented as part of a rack server system **1024**. Alternatively, components from the computing device **1000** may be combined with other components in a mobile device, such as a mobile computing device **1050**. Each of such devices may include one or more of the computing device **1000** and the mobile computing device **1050**, and an entire system may be made up of multiple computing devices communicating with each other.

(154) The mobile computing device **1050** includes a processor **1052**, a memory **1064**, an input/output device such as a display **1054**, a communication interface **1066**, and a transceiver **1068**, among other components. The mobile computing device **1050** may also be provided with a storage device, such as a micro-drive or other device, to provide additional storage. Each of the processor **1052**, the memory **1064**, the display **1054**, the communication interface **1066**, and the

transceiver **1068**, are interconnected using various buses, and several of the components may be mounted on a common motherboard or in other manners as appropriate.

(155) The processor **1052** can execute instructions within the mobile computing device **1050**, including instructions stored in the memory **1064**. The processor **1052** may be implemented as a chipset of chips that include separate and multiple analog and digital processors. The processor **1052** may provide, for example, for coordination of the other components of the mobile computing device **1050**, such as control of user interfaces, applications run by the mobile computing device **1050**, and wireless communication by the mobile computing device **1050**.

(156) The processor **1052** may communicate with a user through a control interface **1058** and a display interface **1056** coupled to the display **1054**. The display **1054** may be, for example, a TFT (Thin-Film-Transistor Liquid Crystal Display) display or an OLED (Organic Light Emitting Diode) display, or other appropriate display technology. The display interface **1056** may include appropriate circuitry for driving the display **1054** to present graphical and other information to a user. The control interface **1058** may receive commands from a user and convert them for submission to the processor **1052**. In addition, an external interface **1062** may provide communication with the processor **1052**, so as to enable near area communication of the mobile computing device **1050** with other devices. The external interface **1062** may provide, for example, for wired communication in some implementations, or for wireless communication in other implementations, and multiple interfaces may also be used.

(157) The memory **1064** stores information within the mobile computing device **1050**. The memory **1064** can be implemented as one or more of a computer-readable medium or media, a volatile memory unit or units, or a non-volatile memory unit or units. An expansion memory **1074** may also be provided and connected to the mobile computing device **1050** through an expansion interface **1072**, which may include, for example, a SIMM (Single In Line Memory Module) card interface. The expansion memory **1074** may provide extra storage space for the mobile computing device **1050**, or may also store applications or other information for the mobile computing device **1050**. Specifically, the expansion memory **1074** may include instructions to carry out or supplement the processes described above, and may include secure information also. Thus, for example, the expansion memory **1074** may be provide as a security module for the mobile computing device **1050**, and may be programmed with instructions that permit secure use of the mobile computing device **1050**. In addition, secure applications may be provided via the SIMM cards, along with additional information, such as placing identifying information on the SIMM card in a non-hackable manner.

(158) The memory may include, for example, flash memory and/or NVRAM memory (nonvolatile random access memory), as discussed below. In some implementations, instructions are stored in an information carrier such that the instructions, when executed by one or more processing devices (for example, processor **1052**), perform one or more methods, such as those described above. The instructions can also be stored by one or more storage devices, such as one or more computer- or machine-readable mediums (for example, the memory **1064**, the expansion memory **1074**, or memory on the processor **1052**). In some implementations, the instructions can be received in a propagated signal, for example, over the transceiver **1068** or the external interface **1062**.

(159) The mobile computing device **1050** may communicate wirelessly through the communication interface **1066**, which may include digital signal processing circuitry in some cases. The communication interface **1066** may provide for communications under various modes or protocols, such as GSM voice calls (Global System for Mobile communications), SMS (Short Message Service), EMS (Enhanced Messaging Service), or MMS messaging (Multimedia Messaging Service), CDMA (code division multiple access), TDMA (time division multiple access), PDC (Personal Digital Cellular), WCDMA (Wideband Code Division Multiple Access), CDMA2000, or GPRS (General Packet Radio Service), LTE, 5G/6G cellular, among others. Such communication may occur, for example, through the transceiver **1068** using a radio frequency. In addition, short-

range communication may occur, such as using a Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, or other such transceiver (not shown). In addition, a GPS (Global Positioning System) receiver module **1070** may provide additional navigation- and location-related wireless data to the mobile computing device **1050**, which may be used as appropriate by applications running on the mobile computing device **1050**. (160) The mobile computing device **1050** may also communicate audibly using an audio codec **1060**, which may receive spoken information from a user and convert it to usable digital information. The audio codec **1060** may likewise generate audible sound for a user, such as through a speaker, e.g., in a handset of the mobile computing device **1050**. Such sound may include sound from voice telephone calls, may include recorded sound (e.g., voice messages, music files, among others) and may also include sound generated by applications operating on the mobile computing device **1050**.

(161) The mobile computing device **1050** may be implemented in a number of different forms, as shown in the figure. For example, it may be implemented as a cellular telephone **1080**. It may also be implemented as part of a smart-phone **1082**, personal digital assistant, or other similar mobile device.

(162) A number of implementations have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure. For example, various forms of the flows shown above may be used, with steps re-ordered, added, or removed.

(163) Embodiments of the invention and all of the functional operations described in this specification can be implemented in digital electronic circuitry, or in computer software, firmware, or hardware, including the structures disclosed in this specification and their structural equivalents, or in combinations of one or more of them. Embodiments of the invention can be implemented as one or more computer program products, e.g., one or more modules of computer program instructions encoded on a computer readable medium for execution by, or to control the operation of, data processing apparatus. The computer readable medium can be a machine-readable storage device, a machine-readable storage substrate, a memory device, a composition of matter effecting a machine-readable propagated signal, or a combination of one or more of them. The terms “data processing apparatus” can encompass all apparatus, devices, and machines for processing data, including by way of example a programmable processor, a computer, or multiple processors or computers. The apparatus can include, in addition to hardware, code that creates an execution environment for the computer program in question, e.g., code that constitutes processor firmware, a protocol stack, a database management system, an operating system, or a combination of one or more of them. A propagated signal is an artificially generated signal, e.g., a machine-generated electrical, optical, or electromagnetic signal that is generated to encode information for transmission to suitable receiver apparatus.

(164) A computer program (also known as a program, software, software application, script, or code) can be written in any form of programming language, including compiled or interpreted languages, and it can be deployed in any form, including as a standalone program or as a module, component, subroutine, or other unit suitable for use in a computing environment. A computer program does not necessarily correspond to a file in a file system. A program can be stored in a portion of a file that holds other programs or data (e.g., one or more scripts stored in a markup language document), in a single file dedicated to the program in question, or in multiple coordinated files (e.g., files that store one or more modules, sub programs, or portions of code). A computer program can be deployed to be executed on one computer or on multiple computers that are located at one site or distributed across multiple sites and interconnected by a communication network.

(165) The processes and logic flows described in this specification can be performed by one or more programmable processors executing one or more computer programs to perform functions by operating on input data and generating output. The processes and logic flows can also be performed

by, and apparatus can also be implemented as, special purpose logic circuitry, e.g., an FPGA (field programmable gate array) or an ASIC (application specific integrated circuit).

(166) Processors suitable for the execution of a computer program include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors, and any one or more processors of any kind of digital computer. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read only memory or a random access memory or both. The essential elements of a computer are a processor for performing instructions and one or more memory devices for storing instructions and data. Generally, a computer will also include, or be operatively coupled to receive data from or transfer data to, or both, one or more mass storage devices for storing data, e.g., magnetic, magneto optical disks, or optical disks. However, a computer need not have such devices. Moreover, a computer can be embedded in another device, e.g., a tablet computer, a mobile telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a mobile audio player, a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver, to name just a few. Computer readable media suitable for storing computer program instructions and data include all forms of nonvolatile memory, media and memory devices, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, e.g., EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, e.g., internal hard disks or removable disks; magneto optical disks; and CD ROM and DVD-ROM disks. The processor and the memory can be supplemented by, or incorporated in, special purpose logic circuitry.

(167) To provide for interaction with a user, embodiments of the invention can be implemented on a computer having a display device, e.g., a CRT (cathode ray tube) or LCD (liquid crystal display) monitor, for displaying information to the user and a keyboard and a pointing device, e.g., a mouse or a trackball, by which the user can provide input to the computer. Other kinds of devices can be used to provide for interaction with a user as well; for example, feedback provided to the user can be any form of sensory feedback, e.g., visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback; and input from the user can be received in any form, including acoustic, speech, or tactile input.

(168) Embodiments of the invention can be implemented in a computing system that includes a back end component, e.g., as a data server, or that includes a middleware component, e.g., an application server, or that includes a front end component, e.g., a client computer having a graphical user interface or a Web browser through which a user can interact with an implementation of the invention, or any combination of one or more such back end, middleware, or front end components. The components of the system can be interconnected by any form or medium of digital data communication, e.g., a communication network. Examples of communication networks include a local area network (“LAN”) and a wide area network (“WAN”), e.g., the Internet.

(169) The computing system can include clients and servers. A client and server are generally remote from each other and typically interact through a communication network. The relationship of client and server arises by virtue of computer programs running on the respective computers and having a client-server relationship to each other.

(170) While this specification contains many specifics, these should not be construed as limitations on the scope of the invention or of what may be claimed, but rather as descriptions of features specific to particular embodiments of the invention. Certain features that are described in this specification in the context of separate embodiments can also be implemented in combination in a single embodiment. Conversely, various features that are described in the context of a single embodiment can also be implemented in multiple embodiments separately or in any suitable subcombination. Moreover, although features may be described above as acting in certain combinations and even initially claimed as such, one or more features from a claimed combination can in some cases be excised from the combination, and the claimed combination may be directed to a subcombination or variation of a subcombination.

(171) Similarly, while operations are depicted in the drawings in a particular order, this should not be understood as requiring that such operations be performed in the particular order shown or in

sequential order, or that all illustrated operations be performed, to achieve desirable results. In certain circumstances, multitasking and parallel processing may be advantageous. Moreover, the separation of various system components in the embodiments described above should not be understood as requiring such separation in all embodiments, and it should be understood that the described program components and systems can generally be integrated together in a single software product or packaged into multiple software products.

(172) In each instance where a specific file format such is mentioned, other file types or formats may be substituted. For example, an HTML file may be replaced by an XML, JSON, plain text, or other types of files. Moreover, where a particular data structure such as a table or hash table is mentioned, other data structures (such as spreadsheets, relational databases, or structured files) may be used in place of the mentioned data structure.

Other Embodiments

(173) It is to be understood that while the invention has been described in conjunction with the detailed description thereof, the foregoing description is intended to illustrate and not limit the scope of the invention, which is defined by the scope of the appended claims. Other aspects, advantages, and modifications are within the scope of the following claims.

(174) Particular embodiments of the invention have been described. Other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims. For example, the steps recited in the claims can be performed in a different order and still achieve desirable results.

(175) A number of embodiments have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention. In addition, the logic flows depicted in the figures do not require the particular order shown, or sequential order, to achieve desirable results. In addition, other steps can be provided, or steps can be eliminated, from the described flows, and other components can be added to, or removed from, the described systems. Accordingly, other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A method for performing incremental secondary analysis of nucleic acid sequence reads, the method comprising: (i) obtaining, by one or more processors of a nucleic acid sequencing device, first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval, wherein each read of the first reads represents a first ordered sequence of nucleotides (ii) obtaining, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, wherein each read of the second reads represents a second ordered sequence of nucleotides, wherein while the second data is being obtained, the method further comprises: (a) providing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data as an input to a mapping and alignment engine; (b) receiving, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device and from the mapping and alignment engine alignment results that indicate a quality of an alignment of the first data; (c) determining, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device and based on the received alignment results of the first data, that the nucleic acid sequencing device is to terminate operations that obtain the second data; and (d) causing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the nucleic acid sequencing device to terminate operations that obtain the second data.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is included within the nucleic acid sequencing device.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein one or more of the first reads includes data representing a first sample identifier, and wherein one or more of the second reads includes data representing a second

sample identifier.

4. The method of claim 3, further comprising: while the second data is being obtained: organizing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the one or more first reads into respective groups based on at least a first sample identifier or a second sample identifier; and generating, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, organization statistics, the organization statistics indicating a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier.

5. The method of claim 1, the method further comprising: providing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, output data that represents the received alignment results of the first data before or while aligning the second portion of the cluster of reads.

6. The method of claim 1, the method further comprising: causing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the mapping and alignment engine to begin a subsequent alignment of the data representing the first plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

7. The method of claim 1, the method further comprising: while obtaining the second data, causing, by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, a secondary analysis engine to determine a set of likely variants for the first data representing the first plurality of reads that was aligned to the reference sequence.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least a portion of the second data representing the second plurality of reads is aligned while at least a different portion of second data representing the second plurality of reads is being obtained.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is instructed to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads a predetermined number of sequencing cycles before the second data is completely obtained.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using a field programmable gate array (FPGA).

11. The method of claim 1, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC).

12. The method of claim 1, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented by using one or more computers to execute software instructions.

13. A system for performing incremental secondary analysis of nucleic acid sequence reads, the system comprising: a nucleic acid sequencing device; and one or more memory devices storing instructions that, when executed by one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, cause the nucleic acid sequencing device to perform operations, the operations comprising: (i) obtaining, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval, wherein each read of the first reads represents a first ordered sequence of nucleotides; (ii) obtaining, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, wherein each read of the second reads represents a second ordered sequence of nucleotides, wherein while the second data is being obtained, the operations further comprising: (a) providing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data as an input to a mapping and alignment engine; (b) receiving, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device and from the mapping and alignment engine, alignment results that indicate a quality of an alignment of the first data; (c) determining, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device and based on the received alignment results of the first data, that the nucleic acid sequencing device is to terminate operations that obtain the second data; and (d) causing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the nucleic acid sequencing device to terminate operations that obtain the second data.

14. The system of claim 13, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is included within the

nucleic acid sequencing device.

15. The system of claim 13, wherein one or more of the first reads includes data representing a first sample identifier, and wherein one or more of the second reads includes data representing a second sample identifier.

16. The system of claim 15, the operations further comprising: while the second data is being obtained: organizing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the one or more first reads into respective groups based on at least a first sample identifier or a second sample identifier; and generating, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, organization statistics, the organization statistics indicating a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier.

17. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: providing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, output data that represents the received alignment results of the first data before or while aligning the second portion of the cluster of reads.

18. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: causing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, the mapping and alignment engine to begin a subsequent alignment of the data representing the first plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

19. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: while obtaining the second data, causing, by the one or more processors of the nucleic acid sequencing device, a secondary analysis engine to determine a set of likely variants for the first data representing the first plurality of reads that was aligned to the reference sequence.

20. The system of claim 13, wherein the at least a portion of the second data representing the second plurality of reads is aligned while at least a different portion of second data representing the second plurality of reads is being obtained.

21. The system of claim 13, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is instructed to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads a predetermined number of sequencing cycles before the second data is completely obtained.

22. The system of claim 13, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using a field programmable gate array (FPGA).

23. The system of claim 13, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC).

24. The system of claim 13, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented by using one or more computers to execute software instructions.

25. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing instructions that, when executed by one or more computers, causes the one or more processors of a nucleic acid sequencing device to perform operations, the operations comprising: (i) obtaining first data describing a plurality of first reads generated by a nucleic acid sequencing device during a first read interval, wherein each read of the first reads represents a first ordered sequence of nucleotides (ii) obtaining second data describing a plurality of second reads generated by the nucleic acid sequencing device during a second read interval that is performed after the first read interval, wherein each read of the second reads represents a second ordered sequence of nucleotides, wherein while the second data is being obtained, the operations further comprising: (a) providing, by the nucleic acid sequencing device, the first data as an input to a mapping and alignment engine; (b) receiving, from the mapping and alignment engine, alignment results that indicate a quality of an alignment of the first data; (c) determining, based on the received alignment results, whether to terminate sequencing operations; and (d) causing the nucleic acid sequencing device to terminate operations that obtain the second data.

26. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein one or more of the first reads includes data representing a first sample identifier, and wherein one or more of the second reads includes data representing a second sample identifier.

27. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 26, the operations comprising: while the

second data is being obtained: organizing the one or more first reads into respective groups based on at least a first sample identifier or a second sample identifier; and generating organization statistics, the organization statistics indicating a number of first reads corresponding to each sample identifier.

28. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, the operations further comprising: providing output data that represents the received alignment results of the first data before or while aligning the second portion of the cluster of reads.

29. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, the operations further comprising: causing the mapping and alignment engine to begin a subsequent alignment of the data representing the first plurality of reads to the reference sequence.

30. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, the operations further comprising: while obtaining the second data, causing a secondary analysis engine to determine a set of likely variants for the first data representing the first plurality of reads that was aligned to the reference sequence.

31. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein the at least a portion of the second data representing the second plurality of reads is aligned while at least a different portion of second data representing the second plurality of reads is being obtained.

32. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is instructed to begin alignment of the second data representing the second plurality of reads a predetermined number of sequencing cycles before the second data is completely obtained.

33. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using a field programmable gate array (FPGA).

34. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented using an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC).

35. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 25, wherein the mapping and alignment engine is implemented by using one or more computers to execute software instructions.
